

MondoWrite

FROM CHAOS TO AN ORDERED WORLD

User guide

All of MondoWrite, step by step: the canvas, the Bible, the Outline, the Manuscript, the Screenplay, the optional AI and the exports, all the way to a print-ready paperback.

Version 1.5.0 ✦ October 2026

Contents

Welcome to MondoWrite 5

One content, four views 5

The app's principles 5

How to read this guide 5

Install and update 6

Download the app 6

Updates 6

The browser version 6

First steps 7

The projects page 7

Your writer profile 7

Create a project 8

Open or remove a project 8

Try with an example 9

Import a manuscript or a screenplay 9

The top bar 9

Your path 11

The architect: plan everything before writing 11

The gardener: write first, structure later 11

The project in development: the Bible and the pitch document 12

The series writer 12

The rewrite: start from an existing text 12

The research-heavy novel: research first 13

The writer on the move: iPhone, iPad, computer 13

The canvas 14

Create a card 14

Card types 15

Change the type: the slash 16

Write in a card 17

Mention another card: @ 17

Connect with threads 17
Move, widen, expand 18
A card's ⋯ menu 19
Images, links and documents 20
Frames 21
Select several cards 22
Organize the canvas 23
Filter and search 23
Undo, delete, the trash 24
To do 25

The Bible 26

The contents 26
The project cover 26
A character's entry 28
The character assistant 29
The relationship map 30
Figures under each entry 31
Other entries 31

The Outline 33

Templates 33
Arrange scenes 33
Chapters 34
List, index cards, timeline 34

The Manuscript 36

The scenes column 36
The page 37
Split a scene, start a chapter 37
Book pages 37
Scene status 38
Statistics and goals 38
Create a card as you write: /Name 38
The Graveyard 39
The panels 39

The spell checker 39
Focus mode 39
Typography as you type 40
Find and replace 40
Check the text 41
Project statistics 41
Write from the card 42
Texts without a card 43

The Screenplay 44

Switch to screenplay 44
The editor 44
Autocomplete 45
The scenes column and “In this scene” 45
Title page and options 46
Statistics, Graveyard and focus mode 46
Check the screenplay 46
Filter by character 47
Screenplay statistics 48
The outline of a screenplay 49
A scene in its card 50

AI, optional 51

Plug in a service 51
What the AI can do 51

Export and publish 53

The manuscript 53
The paperback (KDP) 53
The screenplay 55
The Bible 56
The canvas 57

Your files 58

A project’s folder 58
Markdown copies and versions 58
Syncing between devices 58

Editing outside MondoWrite 59
If saving fails 59

Settings and appearance 60

Dark mode 61
With a finger 61
On iPhone: the Notebook 61

Keyboard shortcuts 61

Everywhere 63
Canvas 63
Text (cards, Bible, manuscript) 63
Manuscript 64
Screenplay 64

Frequently asked questions 65

CHAPTER 1

Welcome to MondoWrite

MondoWrite is a writing workshop for novelists and screenwriters who like to build their story before they write it. You start by dropping your ideas anywhere, you connect them, you sort them out little by little, then you write. Hence its motto: *from chaos to an ordered world*.

One content, four views

Your project is a single set of cards and texts. The four views in the top bar are four ways of reading it: nothing is ever copied from one to another.

View	What it is for
Canvas	The free board where ideas are born: cards you drop, connect with threads and gather in frames.
Bible	The entries of your world (characters, places, plots, themes…), sorted by type on their own, with the project cover at the top.
Outline	The order of the story: templates (three acts, Save the Cat…) to place scenes in, chapters and a timeline.
Manuscript	The text, scene by scene, laid out like a book. In a screenplay project this view becomes **Screenplay**, and the **Outline** lists the scenes in screenplay order.

A scene created in the Outline immediately has its card on the canvas; a character written in the screenplay has its entry in the Bible; the text written in a Scene card is the text of the Manuscript.

The app's principles

- **Structure emerges, you don't set it up.** No required field, no form to fill in: a card is born an "Idea" and becomes a Character, a Place or a Scene when you decide.
- **Three gestures are enough:** type (to create and write), drag a thread (to connect), drop (an image, a link, a file).
- **Your texts belong to you:** everything is saved in a folder of Markdown files, readable with any text editor. No account, no server.
- **AI is optional** and only asks questions and makes suggestions. It never writes for you.
- **Mouse, finger or keyboard:** every action has a path for each. The app comes in English and French, in light and dark.

How to read this guide

The screenshots show the example project that comes with the app, *Little Red Riding Hood* by Charles Perrault (1697), illustrated with Gustave Doré's engravings. Button names are written **like this**. Shortcuts are given for Windows and Linux with `Ctrl`; on a Mac, use `⌘` (Cmd) instead.

CHAPTER 2

Install and update

Download the app

MondoWrite is a desktop application for macOS, Windows and Linux. The installers are published on the project's releases page: github.com/sebastienpiconnier/MondoWrite/releases. Take the latest version, then the file for your system:

System	File
Mac with Apple silicon (M1 and later)	`MondoWrite_x.y.z_aarch64.dmg`
Mac with an Intel processor	`MondoWrite_x.y.z_x64.dmg`
Windows	`MondoWrite_x.y.z_x64-setup.exe` (or the `.msi`)
Linux	`.AppImage` (any distribution), `.deb` (Debian, Ubuntu) or `.rpm` (Fedora)

On a Mac, open the `.dmg` and drag MondoWrite into the Applications folder. On Windows, run the installer. On Linux, make the AppImage executable or install your distribution's package.

> **TIP**
> If macOS refuses to open an app downloaded outside the App Store, right-click MondoWrite in Applications, choose **Open** and confirm. Windows may show a SmartScreen warning: **More info**, then **Run anyway**.

Updates

At launch, the app checks (at most once a day) whether a new version has been published. If so, a banner says so: **Update** downloads and installs the new version, after saving your project; MondoWrite restarts on its own. **What's new** opens the version's page, **Later** closes the banner.

You can also check yourself: **Settings**, **Updates** section, **Check for updates** (also in **About MondoWrite**). The **Check for updates at launch** box turns off the automatic check. Nothing is ever installed without your consent.

The browser version

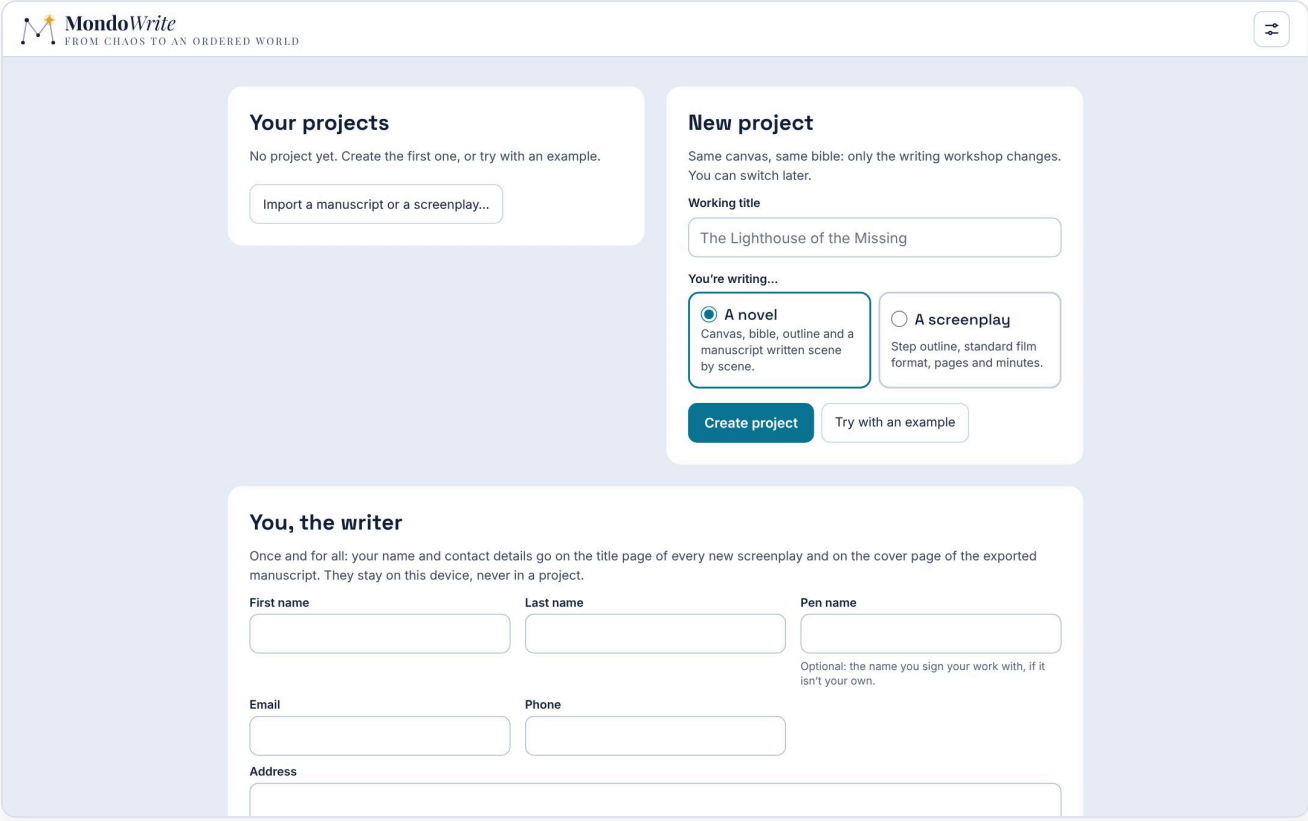
MondoWrite also works in a web browser, to discover the app. Projects are then kept in the browser's storage, not in a folder: for real work, use the desktop app.

CHAPTER 3

First steps

The projects page

MondoWrite always opens on the projects page. It has three blocks: **Your projects** (the ones you have opened on this device), **New project** and **You, the writer**.



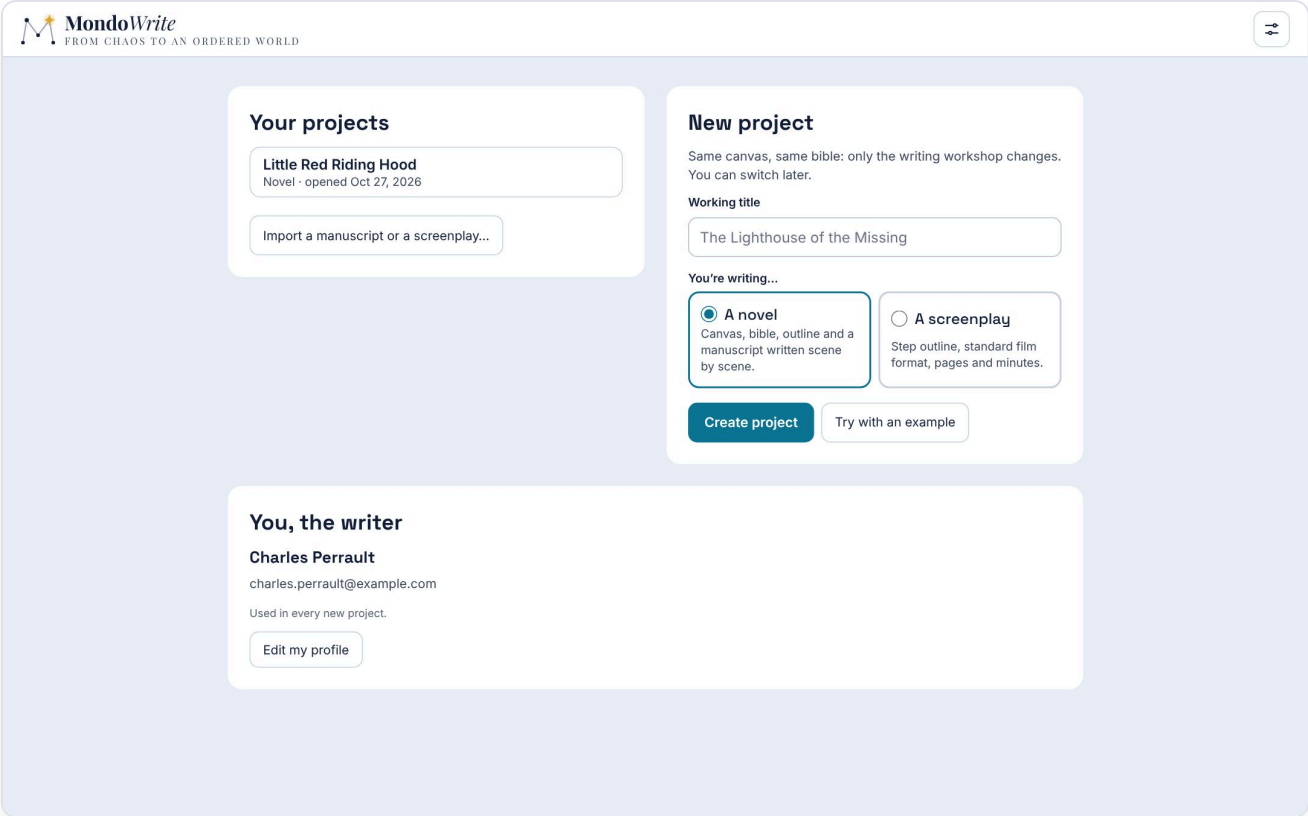
The projects page the first time you open the app.

Your writer profile

Fill in the **You, the writer** block once and for all: first name, last name, pen name (optional: the name you sign your work with, if it isn't your own), email, phone, address, and, if you like, your **Background** and your **Credits or publications** (one work per line). This information stays on your device, never in a project. It is used to:

- sign your exports (the pen name if there is one, otherwise first and last name);
- fill in the cover page of the exported manuscript with your contact details;
- fill in the title page of every new screenplay;
- write the "About the author" page of the documents you send (Bible), with your background and your works.

Once saved, the profile shrinks to your name; **Edit my profile** opens it again.



The saved profile and the example project in the list.

Create a project

1. In **New project**, type a **Working title** (you can change it).
2. Choose **A novel** or **A screenplay**. The canvas and the Bible are the same, only the writing workshop and the vocabulary change. You can switch later.
3. Click **Create project**, then choose the folder to save it in (with iCloud or a cloud folder, it is created there directly, in a folder named after it). A project is a folder: put it wherever you like, including iCloud Drive, Dropbox or OneDrive.

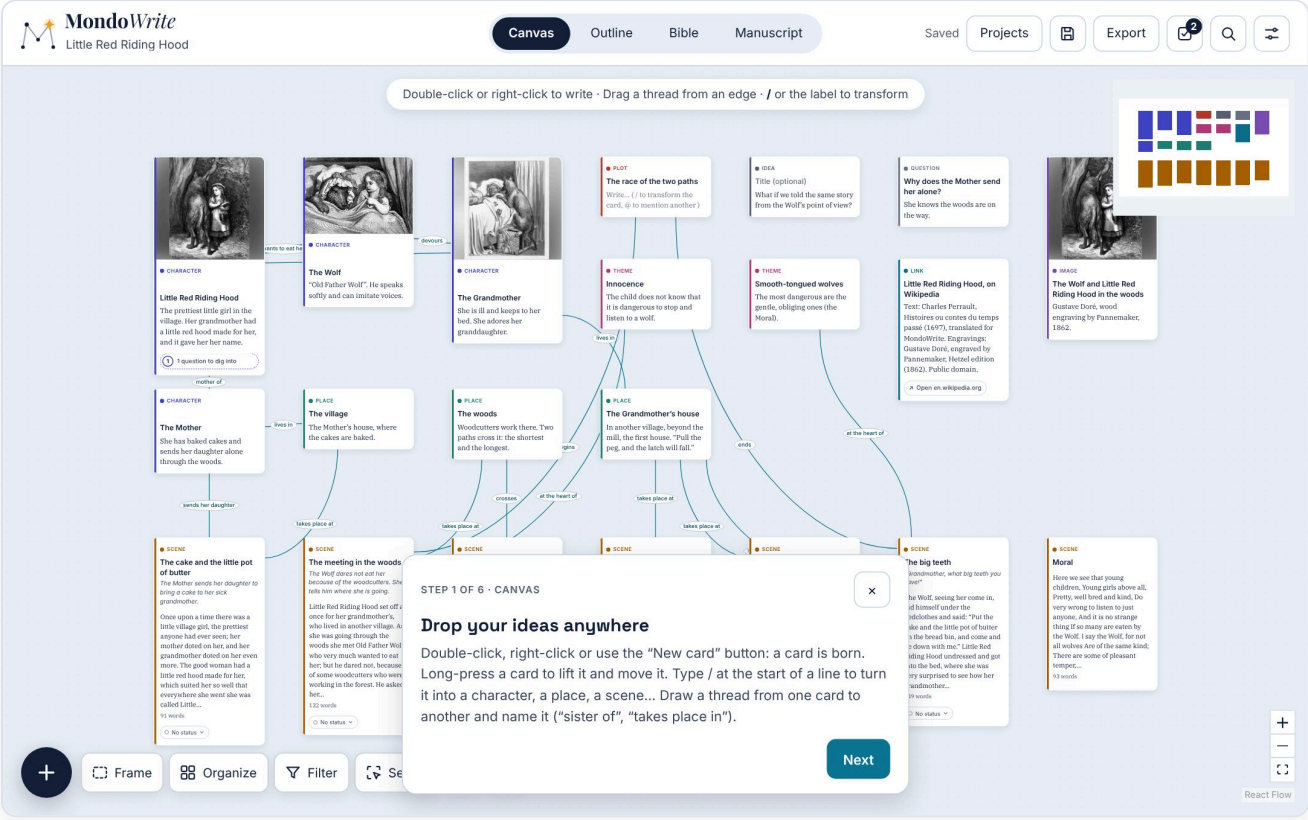
> **GOOD TO KNOW**
> If the chosen folder already contains a MondoWrite project, the app opens it instead of overwriting it. Creating never overwrites anything.

Open or remove a project

Click a project in the list to open it. If opening takes a while (an iCloud project opened for the first time on the device, whose files are still arriving), a window shows how far along it is. **Open folder...** opens a project that isn't in the list yet (copied from another computer, for example). On a computer, removing a project from the list deletes no file: it stays in its folder. On iPhone and iPad, the cross deletes the project after you confirm: its files are erased, from all your devices if it is in iCloud. Export it as a .zip first if you want to keep a copy.

Try with an example

Try with an example creates the *Little Red Riding Hood* project without asking anything (in iCloud or your cloud folder if you have one, otherwise in Documents › MondoWrite on a computer): characters, places, connected scenes, an outline in two chapters, the complete text of the tale and three engravings by Doré. It is the best way to discover the app. A six-step **Guided tour** opens; it stays available in **Settings**.



The guided tour introduces each view in a few lines.

Import a manuscript or a screenplay

Import a manuscript or a screenplay… creates a project from an existing file:

- **Word (`.docx`), Markdown (`.md`) or text (`.txt`)**: a novel project. Chapters are recognised (Word headings, "Chapter 3", bare numbers, page breaks), separators such as `* * *` split scenes, and a title and "by So-and-so" at the top become the project title. A prologue or epilogue of a single scene becomes a book page.
- **Fountain (`.fountain`) or Final Draft (`.fdx`)**: a screenplay project, with its Scene, Character and Location cards. A text file with at least two scene headings (INT., EXT.) is also read as a screenplay.

An import always goes into an empty folder: it never replaces an existing project.

The top bar

Once a project is open, the top bar gathers everything you use everywhere:

- the **project title**, editable with a click;
- the **four views** (`Ctrl` `1` to `4`);
- the **save status** (**Saved**, **Not saved**, **Saving…**);

- **Projects**, which saves and goes back to the list; the disk button (Ctrl S);
- **Export**; **To do** (the tick, with the number of things waiting); the search magnifier (Ctrl F); **Settings**; and the **AI** button if you have plugged one in.

> **SAVING**
>
> You never need to save: the app does it on its own, less than a second after your last change. The disk button forces an immediate save.

When space runs short (an iPad in landscape), the bar stays on a single line to leave the height for your work: **Projects** and **Export** become icons, and the save status moves into the disk button (a dot while it isn't saved). The views only move under the logo if that isn't enough, in portrait for instance. A screenplay's running time and pages are in the Screenplay view.

CHAPTER 4

Your path

There is no right order: take MondoWrite by the end that suits you. Here are seven paths, from the most planned to the freest. Pick yours, and leave the rest aside until you need it.

For each path, the table shows the views that matter right away (●) and those that will help later (○).

Path	Canvas	Bible	Outline	Manuscript or Screenplay	Notebook (iPhone)
The architect	●	●	●	○	
The gardener	○	○	○	●	
The project in development	○	●			
The series writer	●	●	○	●	
The rewrite	○	○	●	●	
The research-heavy novel	●	●	○	○	
The writer on the move	○	○		●	●

The architect: plan everything before writing

For those who want to know the ending before the first line.

1. On the canvas, empty your head: one idea per card, unsorted. Then turn them into Characters, Places, Plots, Scenes with `/`.
2. In the Bible, give your main characters their engine (**Wants**, **Needs**, **Wound, inner conflict**) and each plot its dramatic question.
3. In the Outline, choose a template (three acts, Save the Cat, hero's journey) and file each scene in its slot.
4. **Organize**, on the canvas, then shows the whole structure at a glance.
5. Write in the Manuscript, scene after scene, in the Outline's order.
6. Proofread with **Check**, then export.

> **LEAVE ASIDE**
> At first: the Notebook, exporting the Bible.

The gardener: write first, structure later

For those who discover their story by writing it.

1. Open the Manuscript right away and write. `Enter` twice on an empty line splits the scene, three times opens a new chapter.
2. Type `@` to mention a character or a place: its card is created if it does not exist. Names that keep coming back without a card show up in **Check**, with **Create the card**.

3. The Bible fills itself: under each entry, the scenes where they appear.
4. Later, the Outline without a template shows the order of your scenes; a template then helps you check the pace.
5. What you cut goes to the **Graveyard**, so nothing is lost.

> **LEAVE ASIDE**
> The sheets to fill in and the character assistant: they will help with the rewrite.

The project in development: the Bible and the pitch document

For those who must convince before writing: a publisher, a producer, a funding committee.

1. Fill in the cover, the first page of the Bible: logline, tagline, chips, statement of intent. **Ask me** asks a question for each empty field.
2. Mark your main characters with the star, give them a hook, an engine and an arc.
3. Build the world and the structure: places, groups, rules, plots, and for a series the episodes and **Writing the series**.
4. Look at the questions about the story in **Check**.
5. **Export** › **Bible…** for someone else: choose the look, keep an eye on the page count, add the “About the author” page and, if you wish, the first pages as an appendix.

> **LEAVE ASIDE**
> The Outline and the Manuscript, until the contract is signed.

The series writer

1. Create a **Screenplay** project, then fill in the cover and **Writing the series**: arena, before the pilot, engine, the season’s question.
2. Create one Episode card per episode (season, marker, pivot character) and link it to the plots that run through it.
3. The thread grid, in the Bible export, shows which plots live in which episodes.
4. Write the pilot in the Screenplay view, with the Outline’s “TV episode” template.
5. **Check** tells you if the pilot is too short or too long for its format.
6. Export the series bible for a producer, with the first pages of the pilot as an appendix.

The rewrite: start from an existing text

For those who already have a manuscript or a screenplay written elsewhere.

1. On the projects page, **Import a manuscript or a screenplay…** (Word, Markdown, text, Fountain, Final Draft): chapters, scenes, characters and locations become cards.
2. **Organize** the canvas to see chapters and scenes at a glance.
3. **Check** spots names spelled two ways and characters without a card; the **Statistics** window shows who is present, and who meets whom.
4. Give each scene a status (draft, to revise, done) and highlight the passages “to rework”.

5. **Find and replace**, or **Rename everywhere…** from a card's menu.

The research-heavy novel: research first

For a historical novel, an investigation, a world to invent.

1. Paste links, images and PDFs on the canvas: each becomes a card, with its source sheet (author, date, what I take from it, reliability).
2. Lay down the world cards: Event for the timeline, Rule for its laws, Group for families and institutions, Object, Secret.
3. Set each sheet's **Certainty**: settled, tentative, to explore.
4. Your sources stay in "For you": never in a document you send.

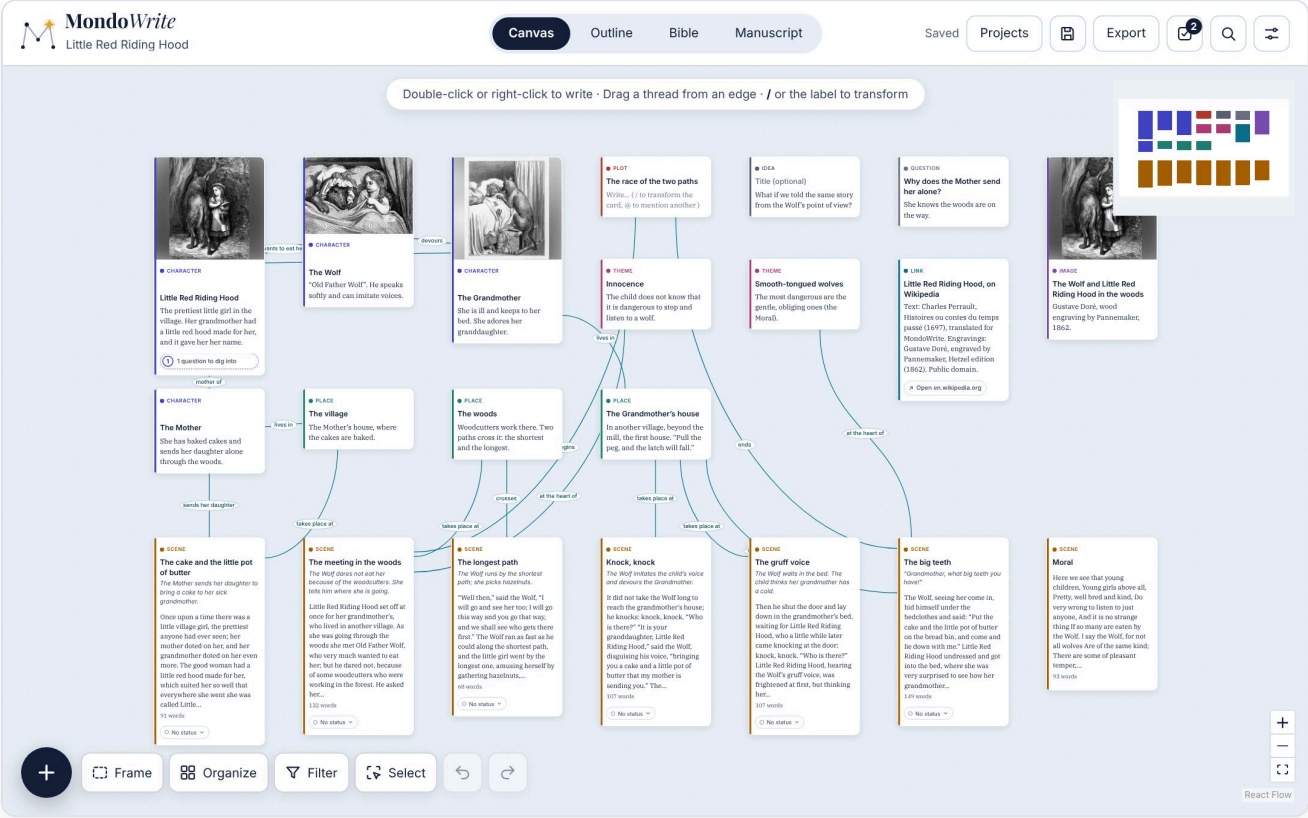
The writer on the move: iPhone, iPad, computer

1. Sync your projects through iCloud Drive (see Your files).
2. On the iPhone, the **Notebook** captures an idea on the go; the Manuscript lets you write a few lines.
3. On the iPad or the computer, **To sort · N**, on the canvas, lists what you captured: place each note and it leaves the list.
4. **Focus mode** quiets everything around the page while you write.

CHAPTER 5

The canvas

The canvas is a large board with no edges. You drop cards on it, connect them with threads, gather them in frames. It is the place of fertile chaos.



The example project's canvas: characters and images at the top, places in the middle, scenes at the bottom, connected by named threads.

To move around, drag the background, or slide two fingers on a trackpad (a mouse wheel works too, with **Shift** to go sideways). To zoom, pinch the trackpad or the screen, or hold **Ctrl** while turning the wheel: zooming also works over a card, even with both fingers on it. A card whose text scrolls keeps the gesture as long as there is text left to scroll. With a mouse, you can get wheel zoom back: in **Settings**, under **Wheel and trackpad (canvas)**, choose **The wheel zooms (as before)**. The **+**, **−** and frame buttons at the bottom right zoom and show the whole board. The minimap at the top right shows where you are; each card type has its colour there.

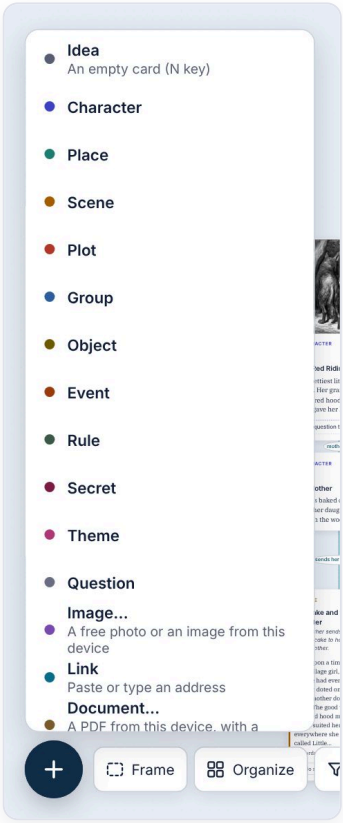
Create a card

There are four ways to create a card, for mouse, finger and keyboard:

- a **double-click** on the background, or a **right-click**;
- the **New card** button, at the bottom left;
- the **N** key, when you are not typing in a card.

The card is born where you clicked, never on top of another one. The cursor is in its **title**; Enter moves to the card's **text**.

The arrow to the right of **New card** opens the list of all types: an empty card, a character, a place, a scene, a plot, a group, an object, an event, a rule, a secret, a theme, a question, an image (free photo or image from your device), a link or a PDF document.



The "New card" menu.

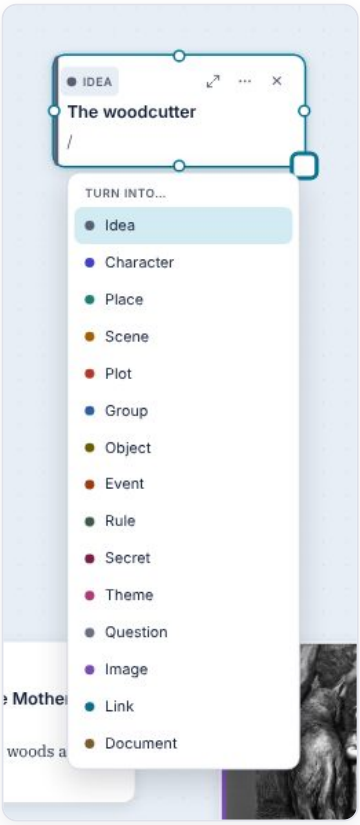
Card types

Type	What it stands for
Idea	The starting type: a loose note, which will become something else or stay an idea.
Character	A person in the story, with their character sheet, motor and arc in the Bible.
Place (**Location** in a screenplay)	A setting, with its period, atmosphere, what happens there.
Scene	A scene of the story. Its text is the Manuscript's or the Screenplay's.
Plot	A storyline (main, secondary, romantic…) with its dramatic question.
Episode (screenplay)	An episode of a series: its number, its synopsis, its pivot character. Threads to plots and characters say who and what runs through it.
Group	A family, a clan, a company, a crew: what it wants, how it works, its means. Its members are the characters linked to it by a thread.

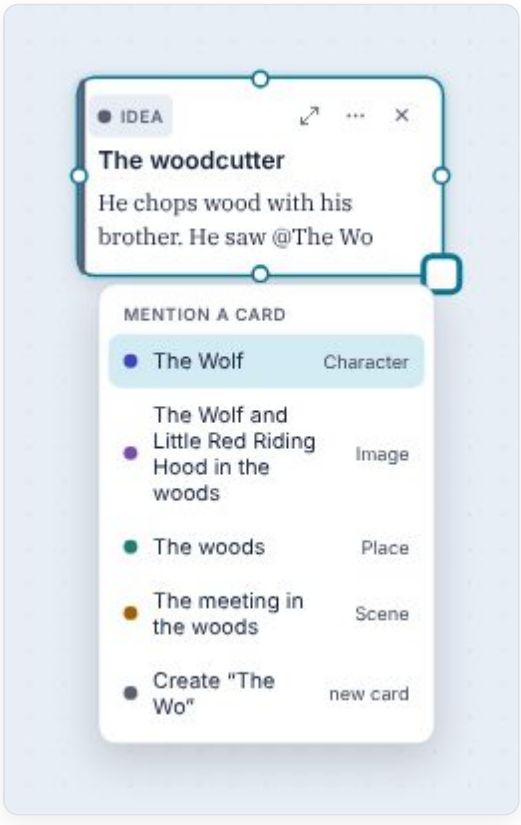
Object	A thing that matters in the story: where it comes from, what it does, what it stands for, where it is.
Event	Something that happened, often before the story: when, what it changed, what people say about it.
Rule	A rule of the world (a magic, a law, a custom): what it applies to, its exceptions, what it costs, what happens to whoever breaks it.
Secret	What some people hide: the truth, the stakes, the clues planted, when and how it comes out. Those who know are the characters linked to it by a thread.
Theme	An idea that runs through the story.
Question	Something to dig into later. Questions are gathered in “To dig into”.
Image, **Link**, **Document**	Your sources: an image, a web page, a PDF, with author and date.

Change the type: the slash

Type `/` at the start of a line of the card’s text (or in an empty title): the **Turn into…** menu opens. Choose with the arrows and **Enter**, or with the mouse. With a finger or the mouse, you can also tap the type label at the top left of the card. Changing the type loses nothing: the text and the threads stay.



“/” opens the type menu.



“@” suggests the project’s cards.

Write in a card

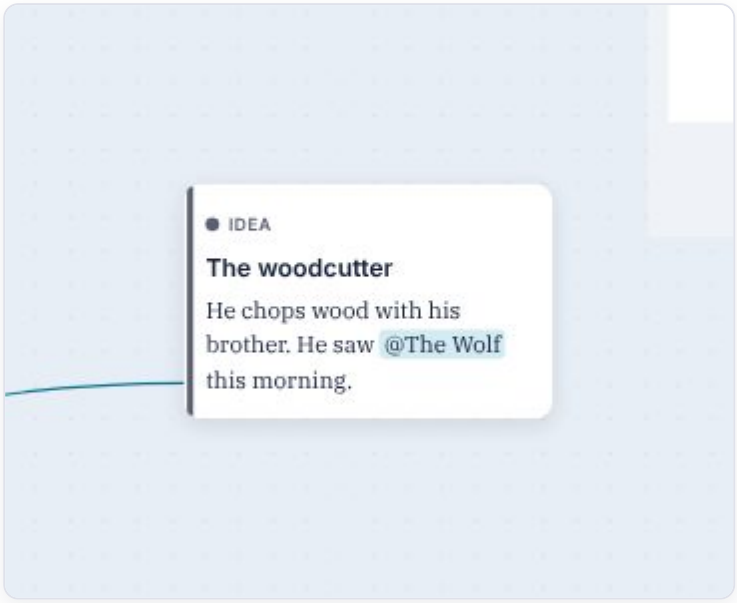
A card's text is formatted like a light word processor. Select a passage: a small bar offers bold, italic, strikethrough, heading, list, checkbox, quote and **To revisit** (a highlight for passages to rework). You can also write Markdown, which turns into formatting as you type: `**bold**`, `*italic*`, `# Heading`, `- list`, `[ ]` for a checkbox. Pasted Markdown text is formatted the same way.

A card whose text is taller than a certain height folds, with **More details** to unfold it; it stays open while you write.

Mention another card: @

Type `@` (or `[[`, as in Obsidian) followed by the start of a name: the list of the project's cards appears. Pick one: its name is inserted as a **mention**, and a thread is drawn on its own between the two cards. If the card doesn't exist yet, **Create "…"** creates it on the spot. It also works in the text of a Bible entry and in an enlarged card.

A mention follows its card: if you rename the card, the name changes wherever it is mentioned; if you delete it, the mention becomes plain text again.

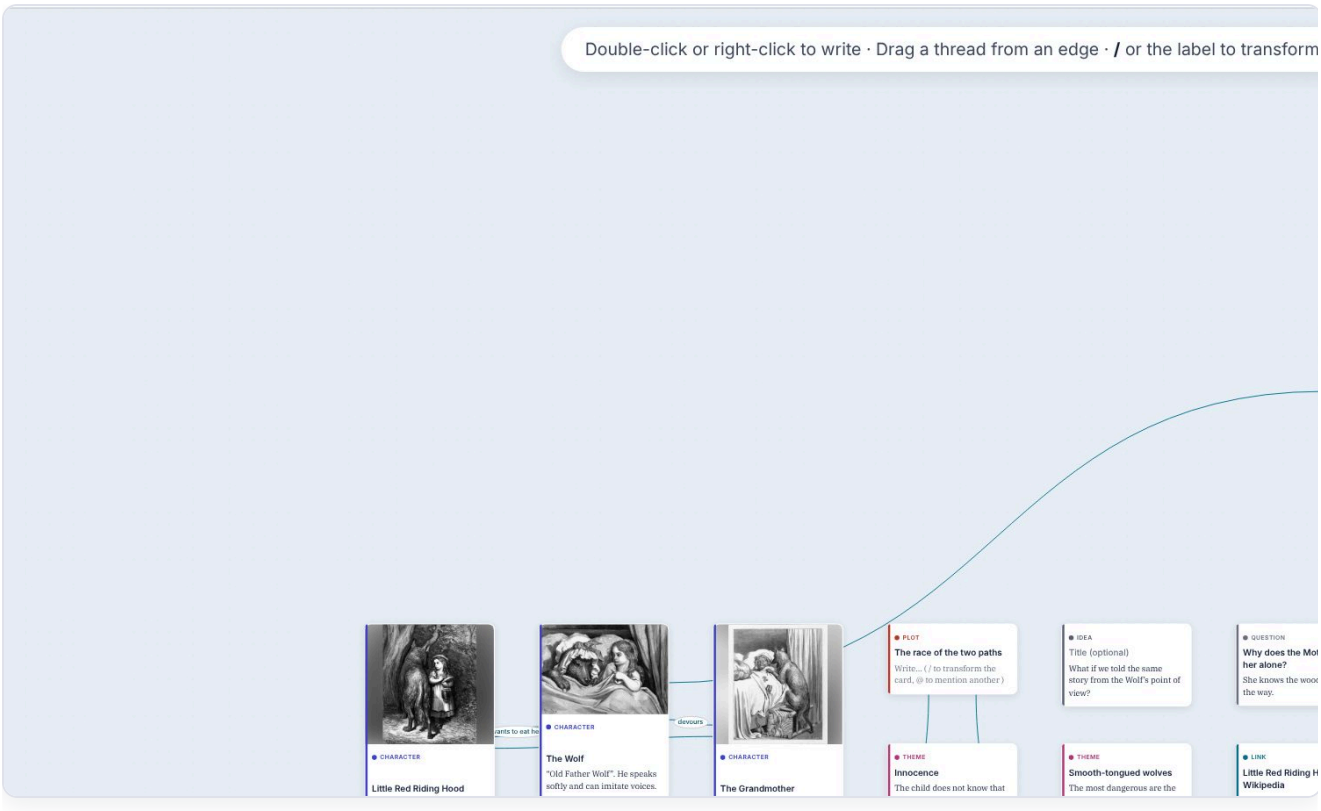


The "The Wolf" mention.

Connect with threads

Hover over a card: a small dot appears in the middle of each edge. Drag from one of them to another card (anywhere on the card): a thread connects them. Click the thread to give it a **label**, the kind of link: "mother of", "takes place in", "suspects"… These labels show up again in the Bible (**Linked to**) and on the relationship map. To remove a thread, click it, then **Unlink**.

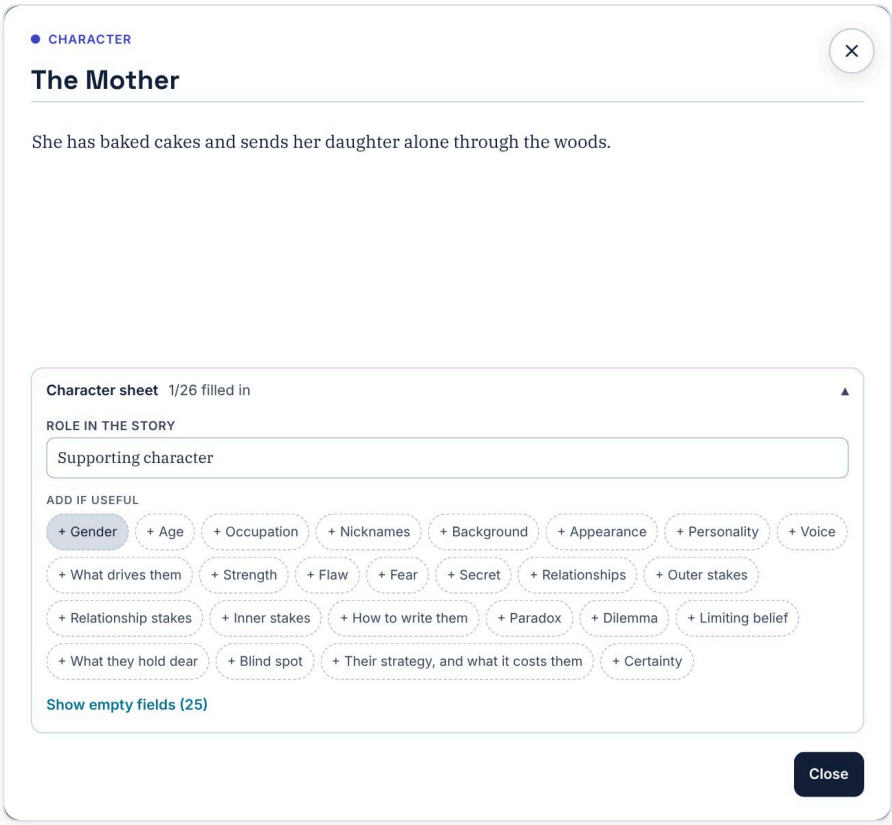
A thread has its own sheet too. In the Bible, touch a card under **Linked to**: three boxes open below the list, **Their history**, **What is at stake between them** and **How it changes**. A dot marks the threads that have a sheet. What is at stake between two characters follows their relationship in the pitch document.



Named threads.

Move, widen, expand

- **Move**: grab the card by its header (or its image) and drag it.
- **Widen**: drag the handle at the card's bottom right corner, or <kbd>Alt</kbd> <kbd>←</kbd> <kbd>→</kbd>. The height always follows the text.
- **Expand**: the two-arrow button (or <kbd>Ctrl</kbd> <kbd>Enter</kbd> on the selected card) opens the card in large, with its full sheet. A click beside it closes it.



An expanded Character card: its text and its character sheet.

A card's ⋯ menu

The ⋯ button (or a right-click outside the card's text) offers:

- **Add an image** or **Change the image**;
- **Filter on this card**: show only this card and its neighbours (connected by a thread or a mention);
- **Copy card** and **Duplicate card**;
- **Rename everywhere…**: change the card's name and replace it throughout the text too (see the Manuscript, "Find and replace").



A card's ⋯ menu.

The sheet button (the small page) of a typed card opens its entry in the Bible.

Images, links and documents

The canvas also keeps your sources at hand:

- **An image**: drop an image file on the canvas, paste it (Ctrl V), or choose **Image...** in the **New card** menu. An image dropped on a card becomes its image. Images are copied into the project folder and keep their proportions.
- **A link**: paste a web address on the canvas. A Link card is born, with the page's title, author, date and image. An address pasted into an empty card turns that card itself into a Link.
- **A PDF**: drop it or choose **Document...**. The Document card shows a preview of the first page, the page count and the author; **Read the document** opens it in the app's reader.
- **Pasted text** becomes an Idea; a dropped `.md` or `.txt` file becomes a card (an Obsidian note keeps its title and type).

Pasted onto a card (click its edge, then Ctrl V), the text goes into that card, at the end: into its notes, or into the scene's text for a Scene card. No card is created.

Copying, pasting and duplicating cards

Select one or more cards, then Ctrl C and Ctrl V: the copies arrive where the pointer is, with their sheet, their images, the scenes' text and the threads between them. Ctrl D, or **Duplicate card** in the ⋯ menu, puts a copy right next to it. In another app, pasting gives the cards' title and text.

A card that changes type loses nothing: a Scene turned into an Idea keeps its synopsis and its text in its notes, and a long text in a card that becomes a Scene becomes the scene's text (a short line becomes its synopsis).

Free photos

Image… opens the **Free photos** window: search for a word (“lighthouse, storm, forest at night…”) and pick a photo. Three sources: **Openverse**, with no key, which gathers openly licensed images (Flickr, Wikimedia, museums); **Pixabay** and **Unsplash**, which need a free key, kept on your device. The photo’s author, page and licence are noted in the card’s sheet. **Choose an image on this device…** takes a file from your computer.



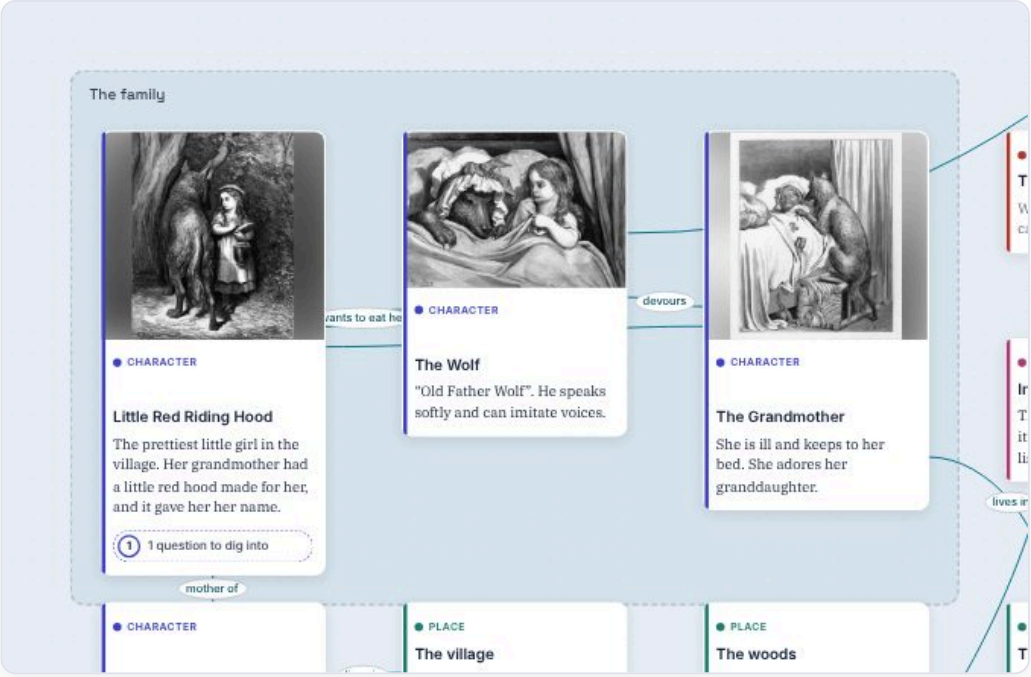
The free photos window.

Frames

A frame gathers cards without imposing anything on them: “The family”, “Act I”, “Research”. Select cards and press `C` (or the **Frame** button): the frame surrounds them. Name it in its header. Moving the frame (by its header, or with a long press on an empty spot inside it, with a finger or the mouse) moves the cards inside; drag its edges to resize it. Deleting a frame doesn’t delete its cards.

With no cards selected, `C` puts an empty frame in a free space near the center of the view. A new card never lands across a frame: created in a frame (double-click, right-click), it stays there, next to its cards; created elsewhere, it goes into an empty space.

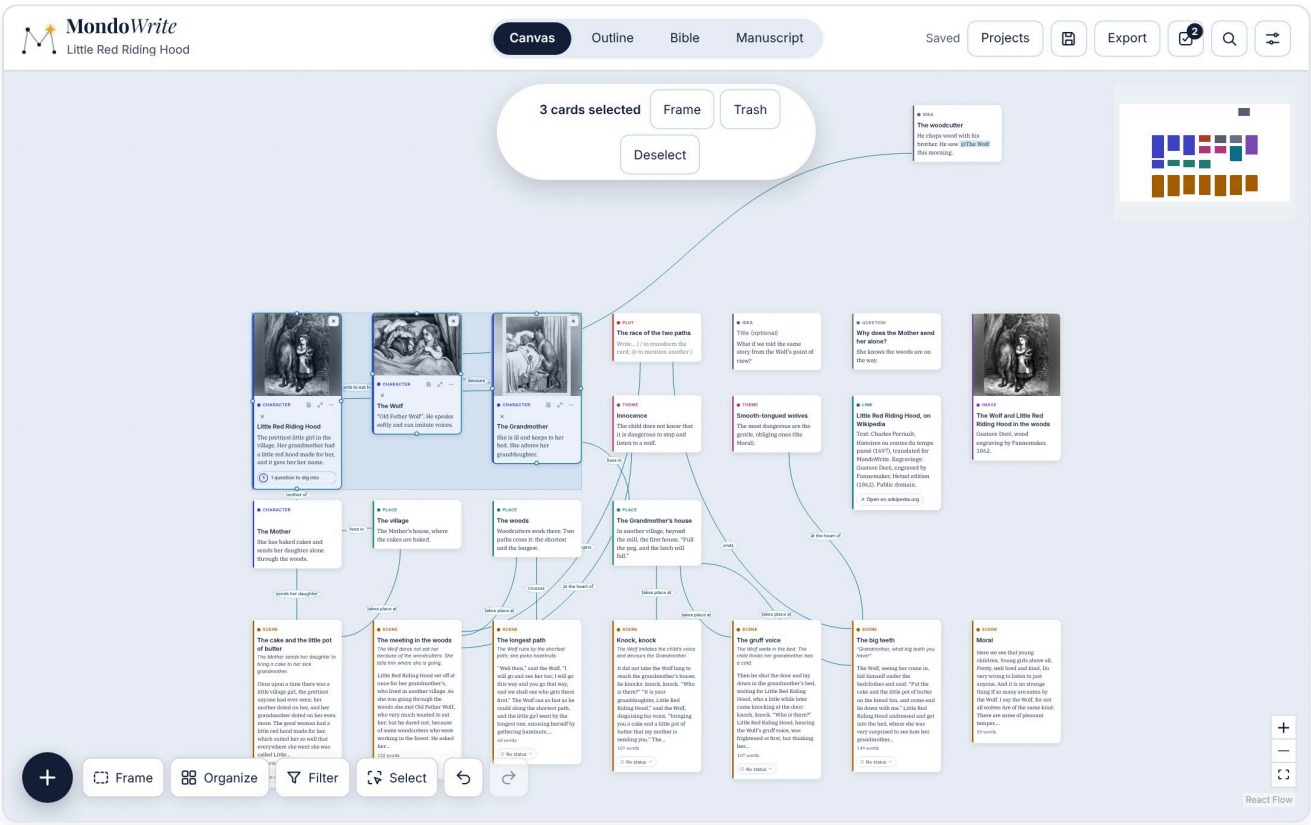
The **padlock** in the header locks the frame: neither it nor its cards move any more, even with **Organize**. The cards stay editable, connectable and deletable.



A "The family" frame around the characters and places.

Select several cards

With a mouse: **Shift** + drag draws around cards; **Ctrl** + click adds a card to the selection; **Ctrl** **A** selects everything, **Esc** deselects. With a finger: the **Select** button makes dragging draw around cards instead of moving the view. A bar at the top then offers **Frame**, **Trash** and **Deselect**; the chosen cards move together.

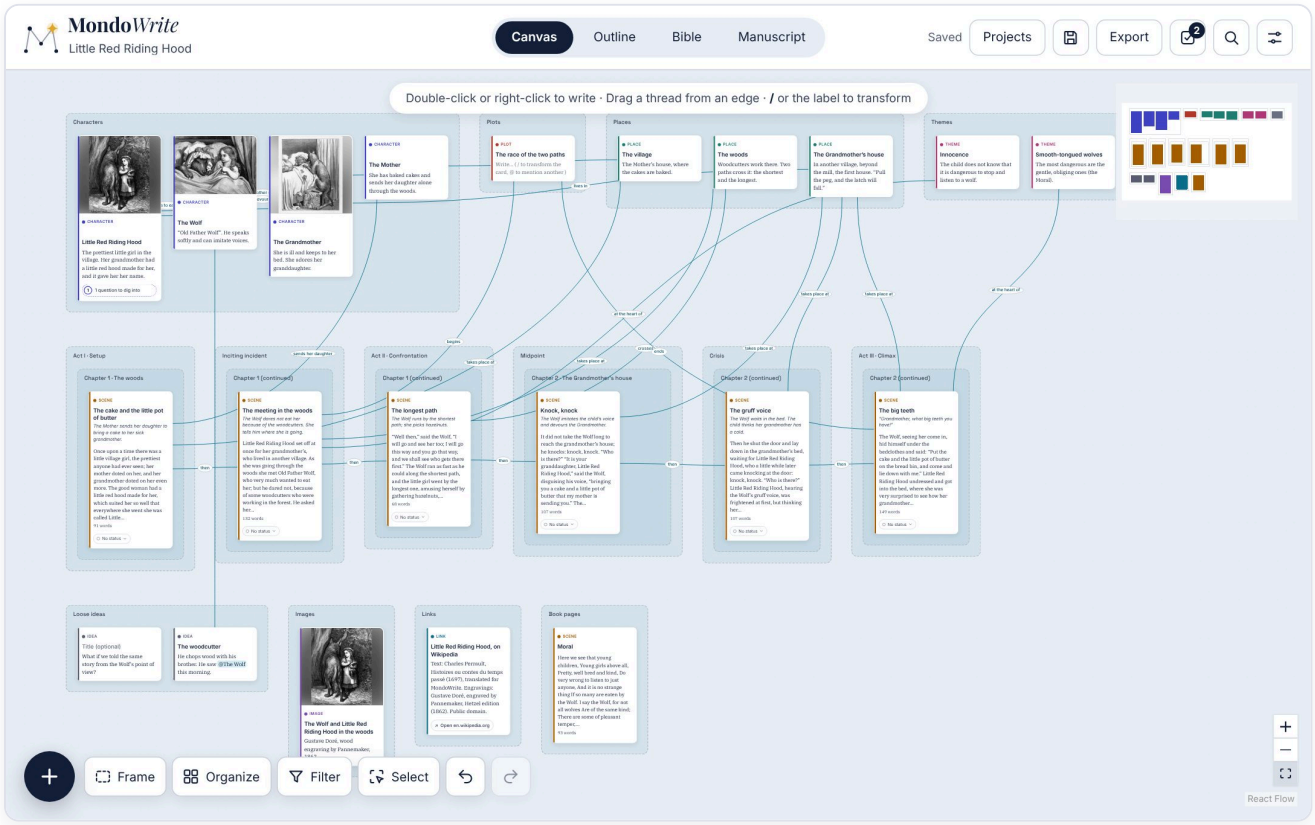


Six selected cards and the selection bar.

Organize the canvas

When everything overflows, **Organize** puts every card in a frame: characters, places, plots, themes, questions, images, links, loose ideas, and scenes by template beat and by chapter, linked in story order by “then” threads. The whole forms a compact block, shaped like the screen: the more cards there are, the longer the rows of scenes, and the frames line up on that width instead of stretching into a long strip. A chapter spread over several beats carries its title in the first one and “(continued)” in the others. Locked frames stay in place. A single undo (Ctrl Z) puts everything back.

After that, the canvas follows the story on its own: moving a scene or a chapter in the Outline, the Manuscript or the Screenplay’s scene list moves it on the canvas too, without going back to **Organize**. An organized canvas is organized again; otherwise the scenes just swap places and nothing else moves.

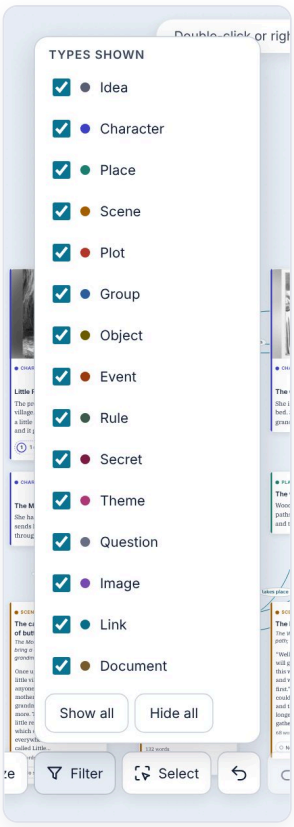


The canvas after “Organize”.

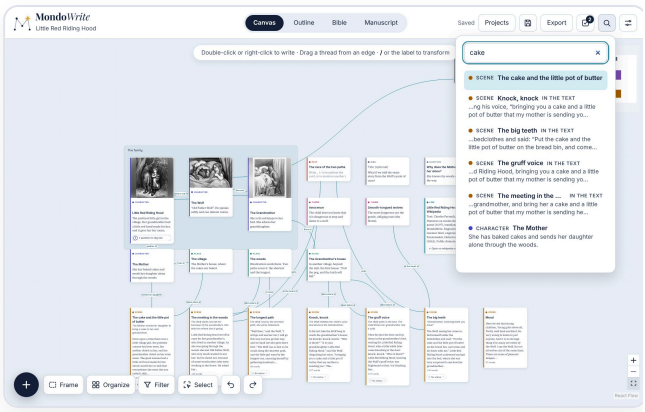
Filter and search

Filter hides card types (nothing is deleted): untick the types you no longer want to see. A “Filter on” banner reminds you at the top (on a phone, the button’s funnel turns solid instead); **Show all** brings everything back, and **Hide all** unticks every type at once (handy to keep just one or two).

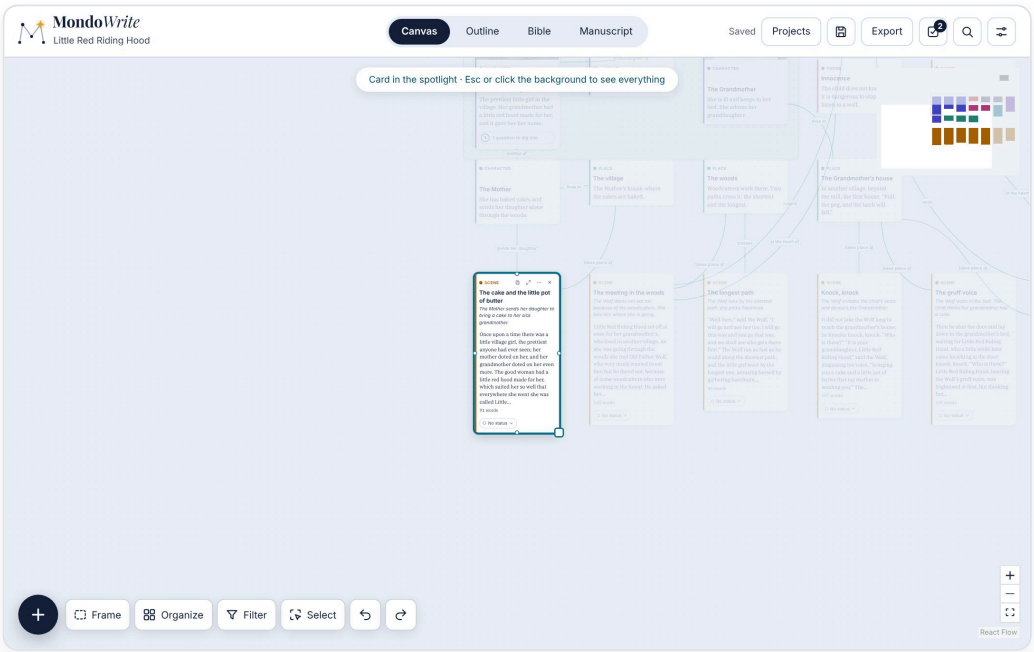
The magnifier (Ctrl F) searches card titles and text, ignoring case and accents, and also the text of scenes (“in the text”). Pick a result: the canvas centers on the card, at 50 %, and puts it in the spotlight (the others fade; Esc or a click on the background brings everything back), or the scene opens in the Manuscript.



Filtering by type.



Search, in cards and in the text.



The chosen result, in the spotlight on the canvas.

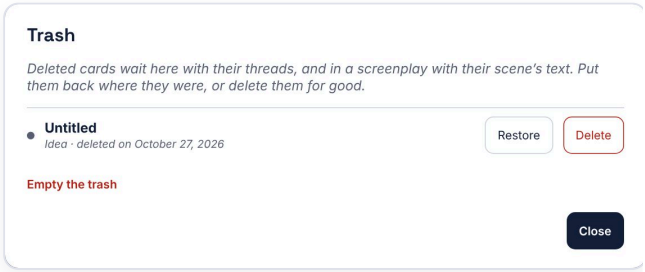
Undo, delete, the trash

Undo and **Redo** (at the bottom, or Ctrl Z and Ctrl Shift Z) undo and redo changes to the canvas, the outline and the trash. Inside a text, these shortcuts undo typing.

Deleting a card (the card's ×, or Delete) moves it to the **trash**, with its place and threads. A message immediately offers **Undo**. The trash opens from **Settings** (**Trash (n)**): **Restore** puts the card back, **Delete** erases it for good. A scene's text is never lost with its card.



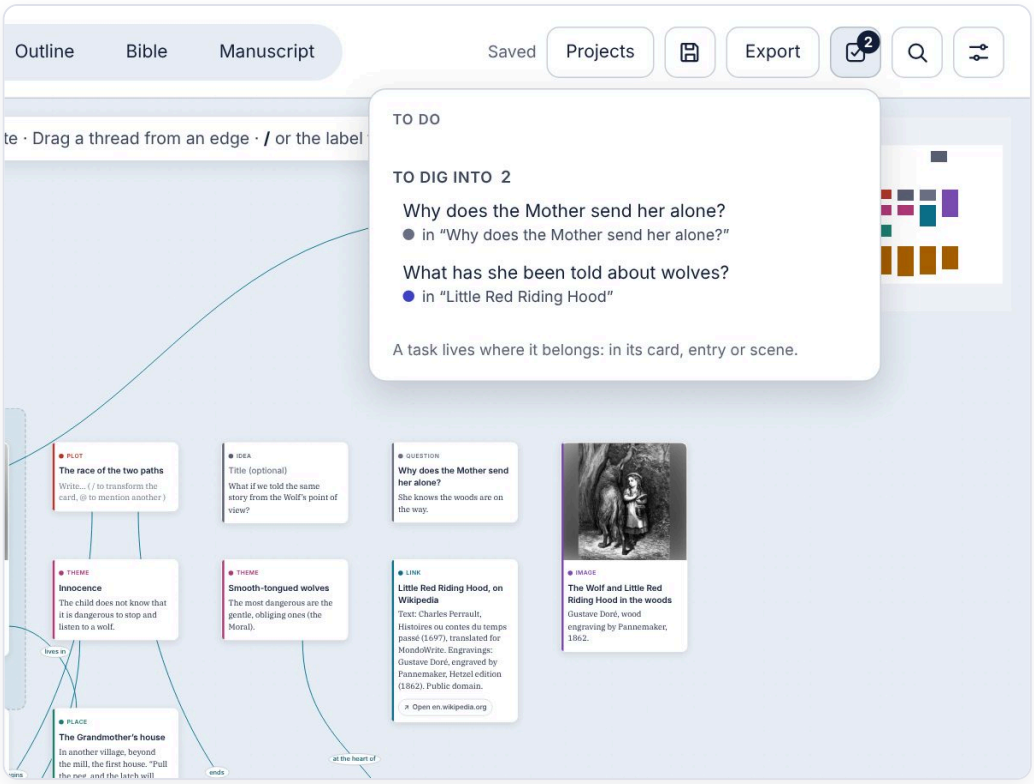
The message after a deletion.



The trash.

To do

The **To do** button (Ctrl Shift L) gathers everything that is waiting: unticked boxes in your cards, passages marked **To revisit** in the manuscript, and the questions **To dig into** (questions kept in a character's entry and Question cards). A task stays where you put it: ticking it in the panel ticks it in its card.



The "To do" panel.

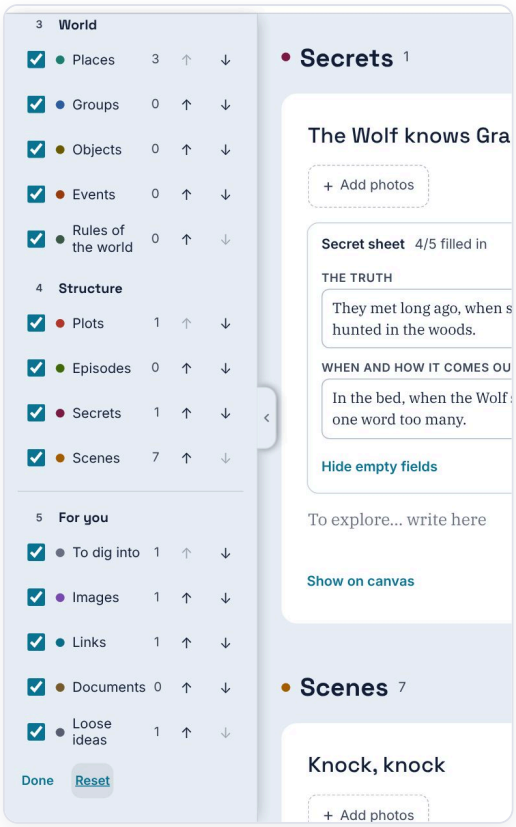
CHAPTER 6

The Bible

The Bible gathers the entries of your world. It builds itself: each typed card on the canvas has its entry there, sorted by type. Nothing is copied: editing an entry edits the card.

The contents

On the left, the **contents** arrange the sections in five numbered parts, in the order of a pitch pack: **1 · Presentation** (the project, the themes), **2 · Characters**, **3 · World** (the places), **4 · Structure** (storylines and scenes) and, set apart, **5 · For you** (questions to dig into, images, links, documents, loose ideas): what is just for you, never printed in a pack you send out. Each section shows its number of entries; a click takes you there. Each section's **+** button creates an entry there (and so a card on the canvas). Each entry collapses with its arrow, top right, to show only its title; **Collapse all** and **Expand all** do the same for the whole section. The device remembers it from one session to the next, and an entry opened from the canvas expands by itself. **Choose and order sections** lets you hide sections and change their order within their part, with the arrows; this setting also applies to the Word and Markdown export of the Bible.



Choose and order sections.

The project cover

The Bible opens on the cover: your book's identity card, useful to present it to a publisher, an agent or a producer.

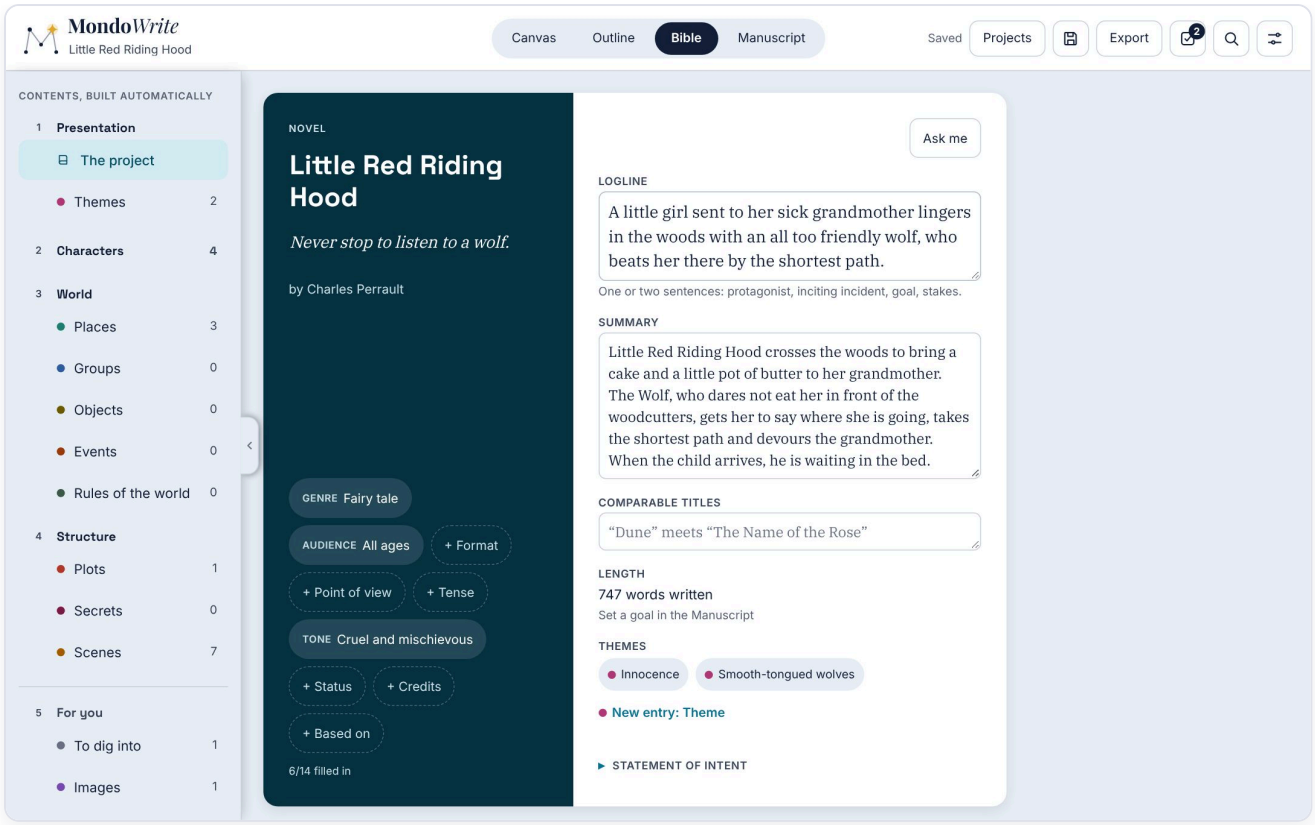
- the **jacket**: title, **tagline** (one line that makes people want more) and **chips** for genre, audience, format, point of view, tense, tone, status (first draft, rewriting…), credits and the work the project is adapted from (**Based on**). Suggestions are offered, or free text with **Other**;
- the **logline** (who wants what, what stands in the way, what is at stake), the **summary**, the **comparable titles** (“Dune” meets “The Name of the Rose”) and the **statement of intent**;
- the **length**, computed from the manuscript (words written and goal), and the **themes**, which are your Theme cards.

Ask me, top right of the cover, asks one question at a time for each empty field (“Who wants what, what stands in the way, and what’s at stake?” for the logline). Your answer goes as it is into the field, with **Add**; **Another one** moves to the next question. Like the character assistant, it never answers for you.

In a **screenplay**, the cover also has a folding part, **Writing the series**, for everything that helps a producer believe in it and a writer join it: **Why now**, **Why me**, **The promise** (what viewers come back for, episode after episode), **What it is not**, **The arena**, **Before the pilot** (what happened before episode one), **What holds them together** (why your characters cannot walk away), **The engine** (the central conflict that makes the episodes), **A typical episode**, **The season’s question**, **Where the season ends**, **Future seasons**, **Do**, **Don’t**, **Where it could go next** and **Other platforms** (podcast, graphic novel, game: only printed in a document you send). Two more chips under the title: **Shape** (episodic, serialized, hybrid) and **Pilot** (premise pilot or template pilot).

Episodes are Episode cards, kept in the Structure part of the Bible, in the order of their number. **New episode**, on the cover, creates one. Each has a synopsis of three or four sentences, a **Pivot character**, chosen among your characters, a **Season** (1 if nothing is written; from two seasons on, numbers read “2.3”) and an optional **Marker**, **Midseason** or **Season finale**; draw a thread from the episode to the plots that run through it and the characters who appear in it. A project that wrote its episodes on the cover, one per line, finds them as cards when it opens.

Under the note of intent, a discreet marker gives its length: a page is about 450 words.

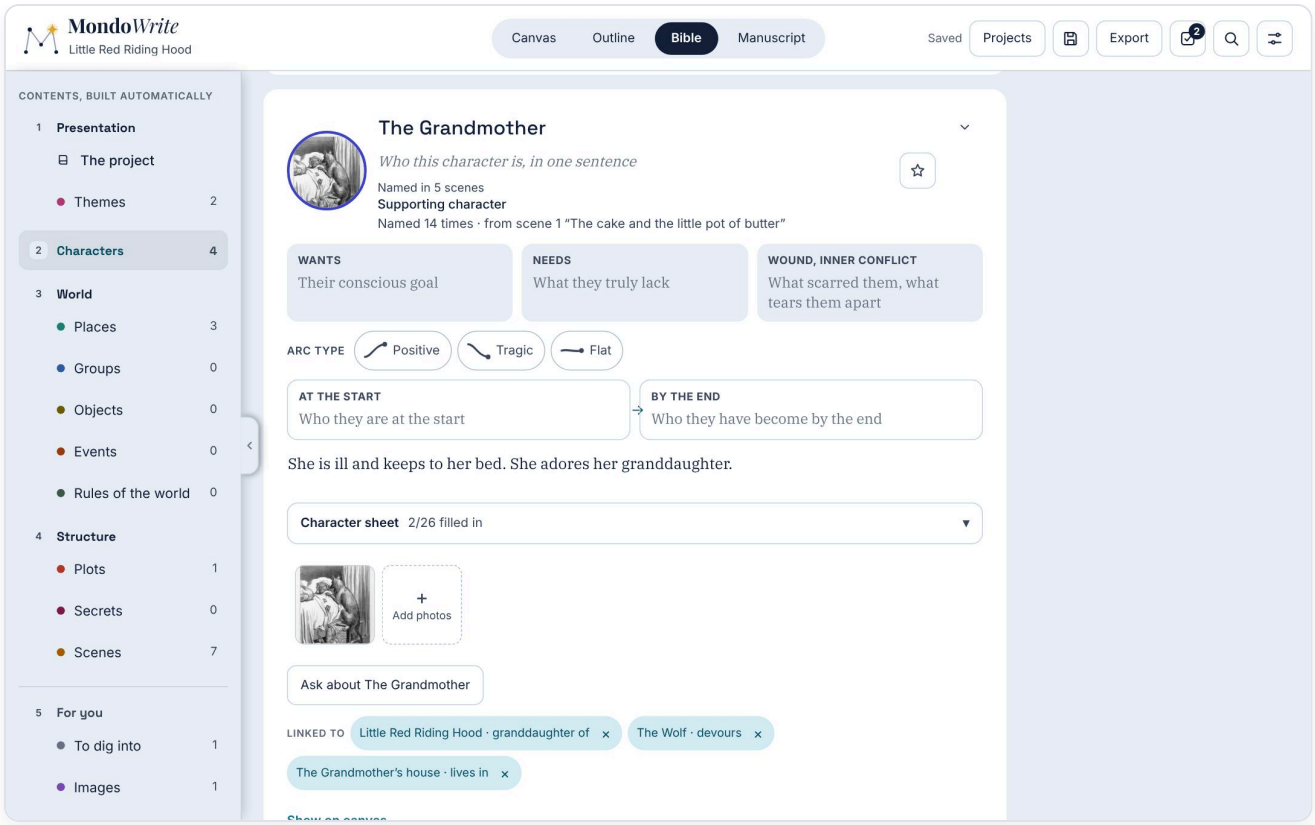


The project cover, at the top of the Bible.

A character's entry

Each character has an entry that gets to the point:

- their **portrait** (the card's image, in a circle), their role, and how many times they are mentioned in the manuscript, from which scene;
- under their name, their **hook**: who they are, in one sentence. The pitch pack uses it too;
- the **star** next to the name marks them as a **Main character**: they come first in the section and, in a pack you send out, get a page of their own; the others are grouped under "Also";
- their **motor**: what they want (**Wants**), what they need (**Needs**), and their **Wound, inner conflict**. If their role says "antagonist", the motor becomes **Motivation**, **Strength**, **Flaw**;
- their **arc type**, drawn: **Positive** (they grow), **Tragic** (they fall), **Flat** (they don't change but change the world), then their arc in two steps: **At the start** and **By the end**;
- your free **text** (the card's text), editable in place;
- the folded **character sheet**: gender, age, occupation, nicknames, origin, appearance, personality, voice, fear, secret, relationships… Everything is optional. Empty fields wait under **Add if useful**: a tap opens one. You will also find the three levels of stakes there (**Outer stakes**, **Relationship stakes**, **Inner stakes**) and **How to write them**, useful for a series bible, then more to dig into: **Paradox**, **Dilemma**, their limiting belief, what they hold dear, their **Blind spot**, their strategy and what it costs them;
- the **gallery** of reference photos (**Add photos**), and the **Linked to** cards, with each thread's label.

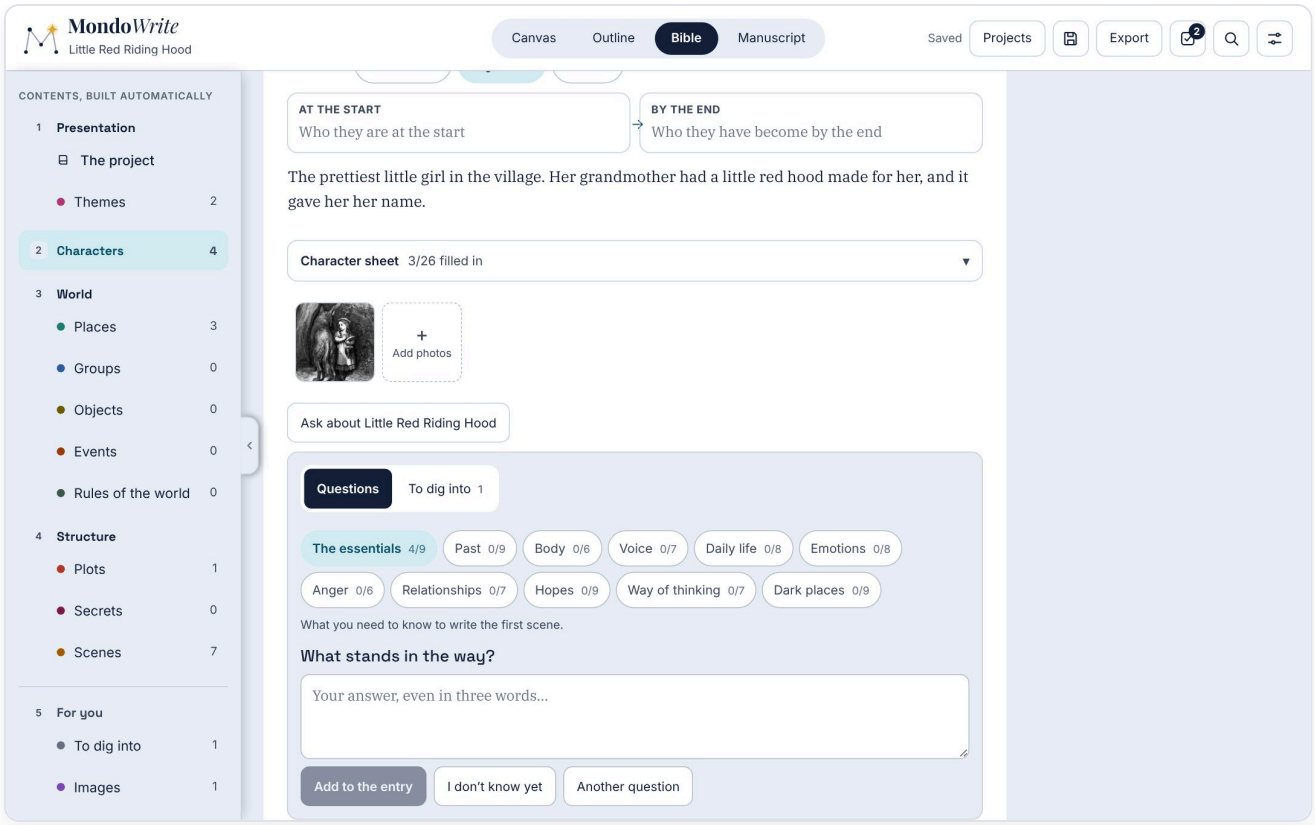


The Grandmother's entry: portrait, motor, arc, text, character sheet, gallery and links.

The character assistant

Ask about … opens the assistant, which helps you dig into a character by asking questions, one at a time. It never answers for you.

- Questions are sorted by **theme**: **The essentials**, **Past**, **Body**, **Voice**, **Daily life**, **Emotions**, **Anger**, **Relationships**, **Hopes**, **Way of thinking**, **Dark places**. Each theme shows how many questions have an answer.
- Write your answer, even in three words, then **Add to the entry**. If the question matches a field of the sheet, the answer goes into that field; otherwise it is kept in **Answers to questions**, below the sheet.
- **I don't know yet** keeps the question for later, in the **To dig into** tab (and in "To do"). **Another question** moves to the next one.
- With an AI plugged in, **Tailored** asks for a question written from the entry, and **AI summary** puts what you wrote in order (see the AI chapter).

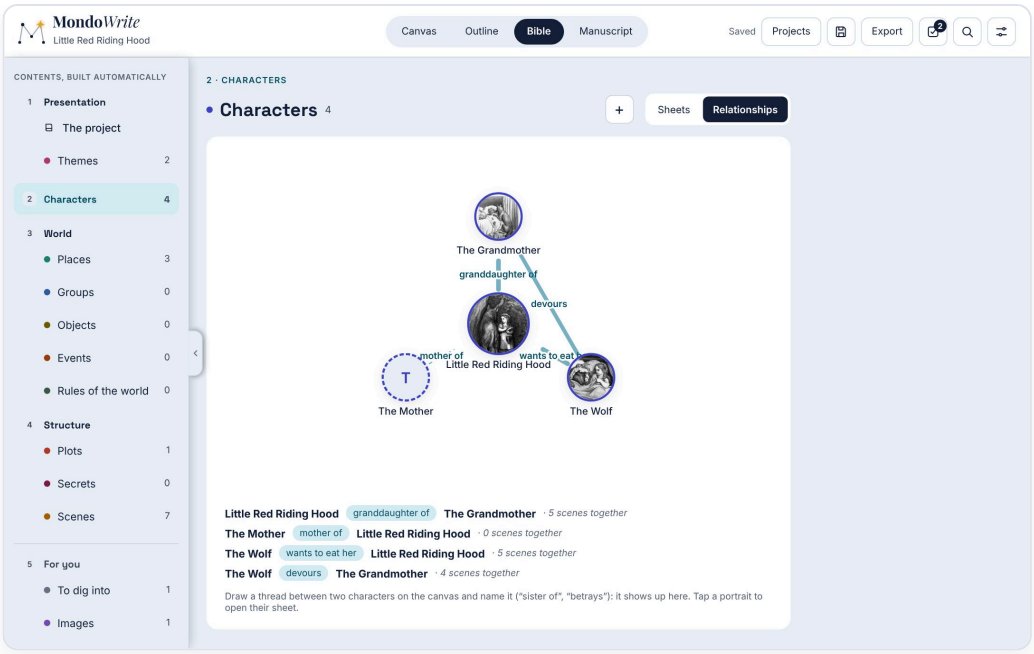


The assistant asks a question from “The essentials”.

The relationship map

In the Characters section, the **Relationships** tab draws the characters and the threads that connect them on the canvas, with their labels, then the list of relationships. Draw a thread between two characters and name it (“sister of”, “betrays”): it shows up here. Tap a portrait to open their entry.

A thread gets thicker with the number of scenes the two characters share, and the list spells it out (“3 scenes together”). A dotted thread joins two characters who never share a scene: a relationship the story doesn’t show yet.



The relationships between the tale's characters.

Figures under each entry

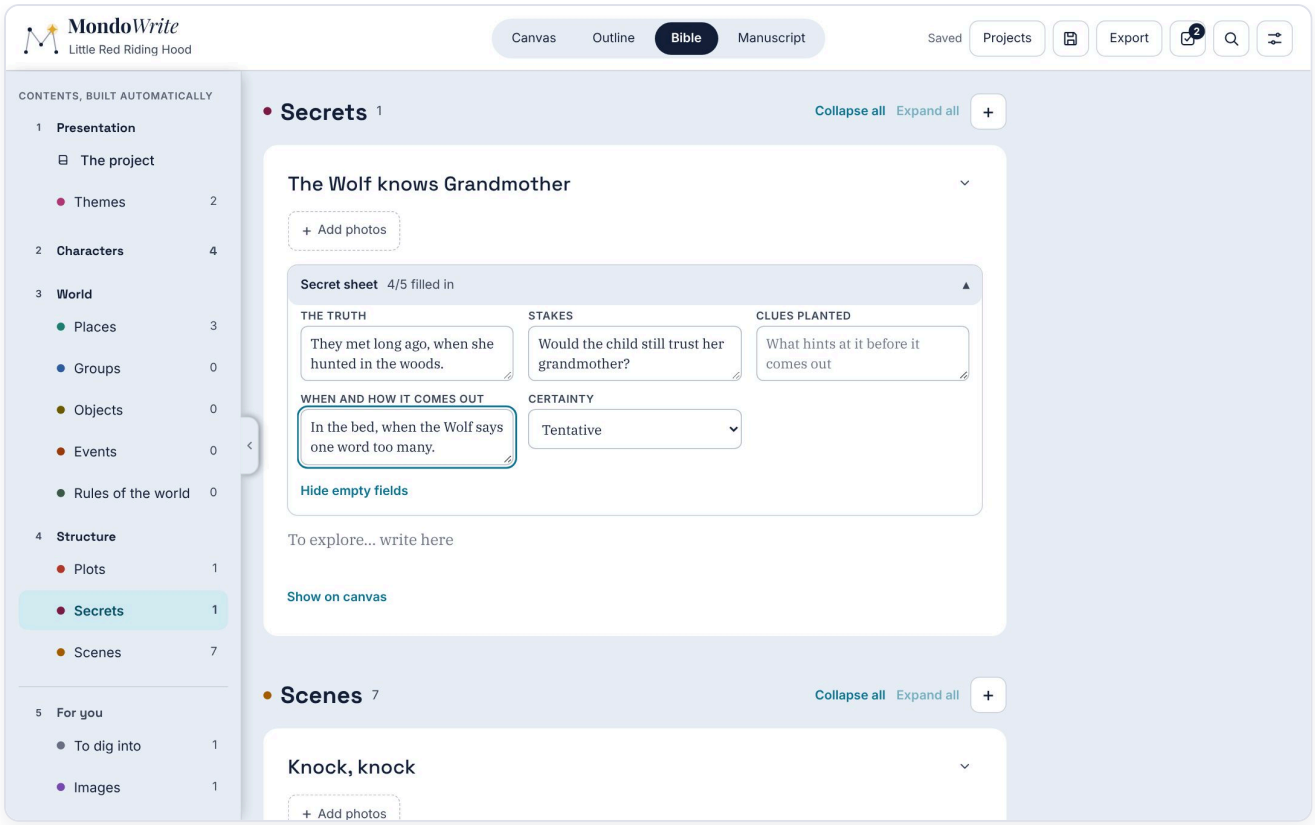
Under each character's name, a discreet line gives their scenes (and, in a screenplay, their lines and share of speaking time); under each place's name, its scenes (and for a location, its pages, interior or exterior, day or night). Everything is read from your text. The details, sorting and CSV export are in the **Statistics** window, opened from the Manuscript or the Screenplay (see "Project statistics").

Other entries

Each type has its sheet, folded under the text:

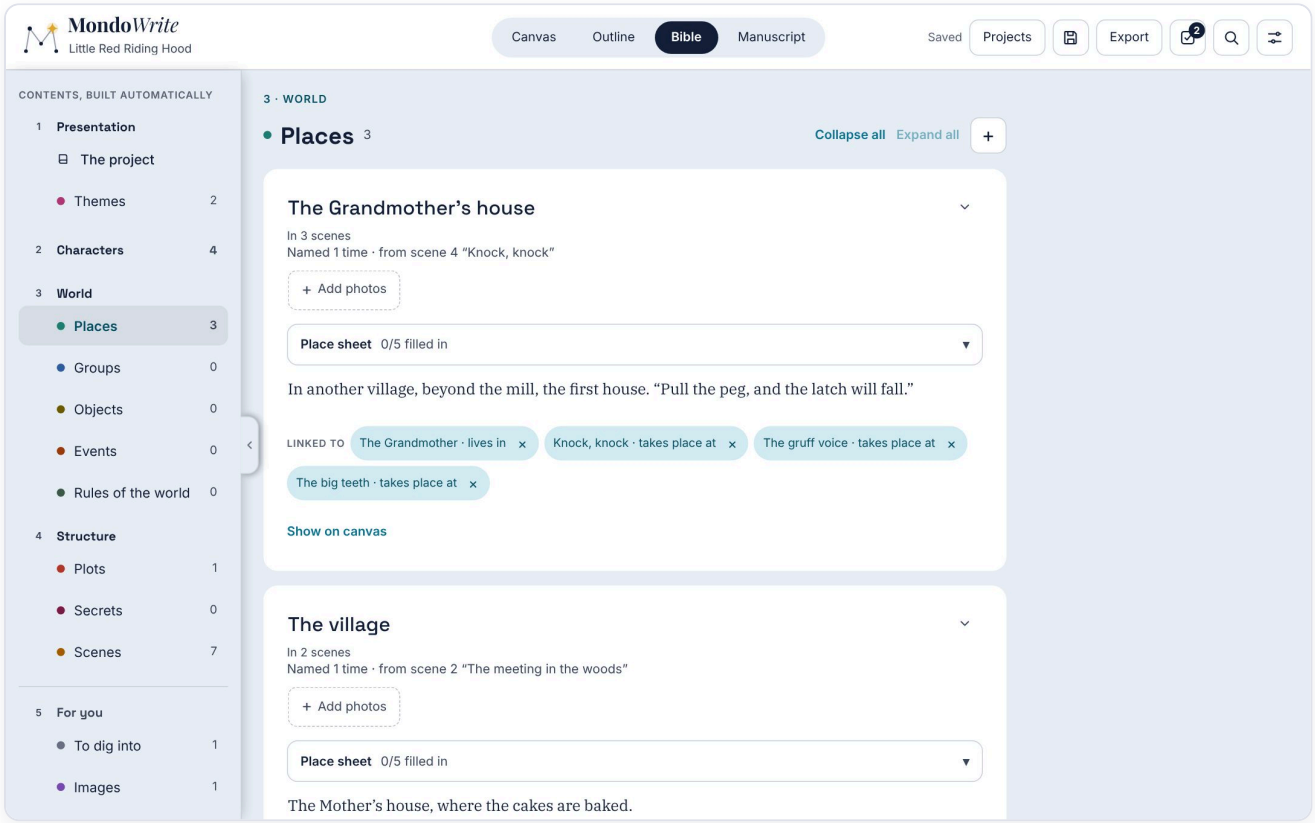
- **Place**: period, atmosphere (sounds, smells, light), what happens there, why it matters. The number of scenes set there is shown.
- **Plot**: nature, dramatic question, stakes, trigger, obstacles, turning point, resolution.
- **Episode**: number, season, marker, synopsis, pivot character.
- **Group, Object, Event, Rule, Secret**: see "Card types".
- **Scene**: its synopsis, its status and the start of its text (a click opens it to write), then, if useful, its goal, its obstacle, its turn and what changed by the end.
- **Question**: its **Status** (open, decided, dropped) and what was decided. A settled question moves to the end of the section, in gray.
- **Link, Image, Document**: address, author, publication, date accessed, what you take from it, its reliability. **Fill in from the page** fetches the title and author from the web page.

Every sheet except a scene's has a **Certainty** box: **Settled**, **Tentative** or **To explore**. It tells you what you can build on; it never appears in a document you send.



A secret, its truth, its reveal and its certainty.

Questions **To dig into** and loose ideas have their own sections too. **Show on canvas**, at the bottom of each entry, shows its card in the spotlight: the others fade until you click the background or press **Esc**.



The places section.

CHAPTER 7

The Outline

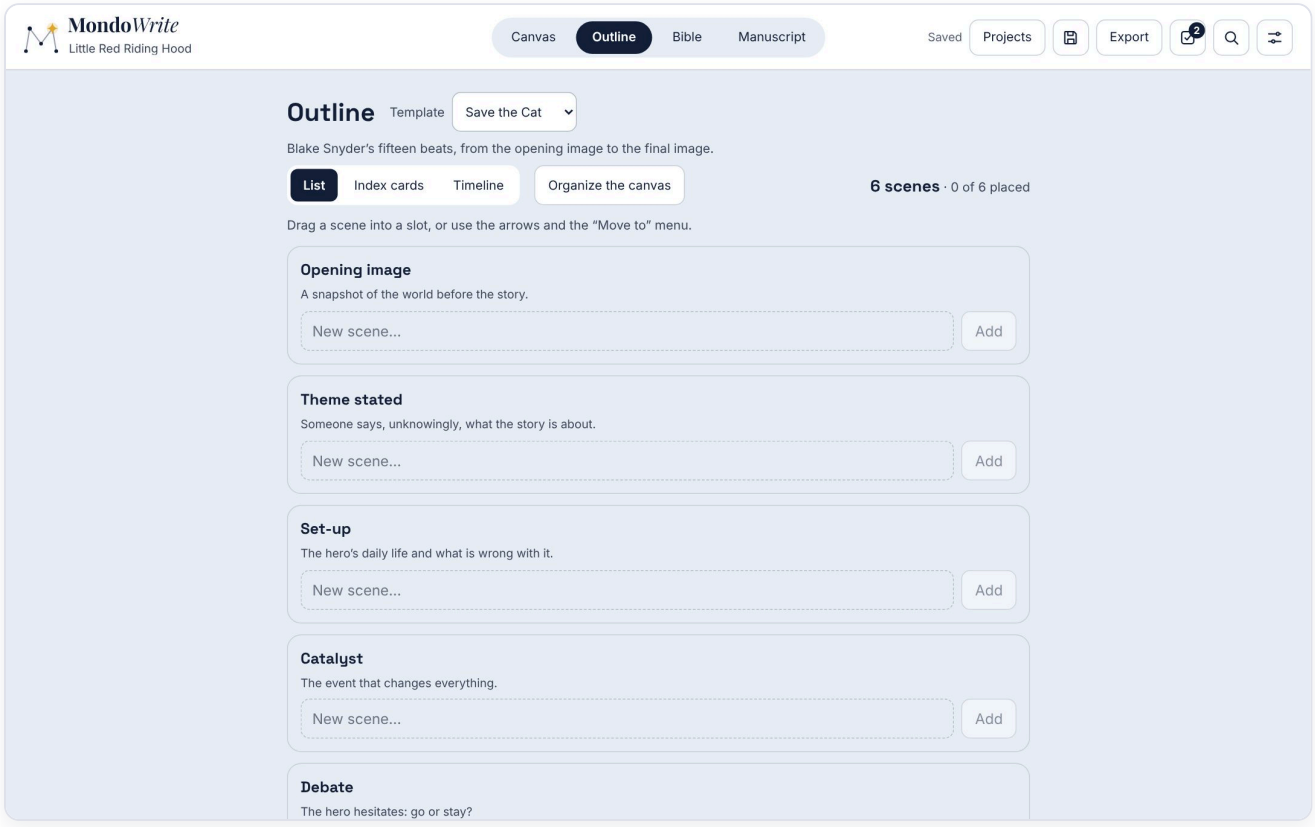
The Outline shapes the story: the order of scenes, their place in a structure, their chapters. It contains only scenes: those of the canvas, the Bible or the Manuscript, always the same ones.

Templates

The **Template** menu offers a structure, with a sentence that explains it:

- **Free**: a single list, in the order you arrange the scenes;
- **Three acts**: setup, inciting incident, confrontation, midpoint, crisis, climax, resolution;
- **Save the Cat**: Blake Snyder's fifteen beats, from the opening image to the final image;
- **Hero's journey**: Christopher Vogler's twelve stages, after Joseph Campbell.

Each beat has a name and a hint. Changing templates loses no arrangement: each template keeps its own.



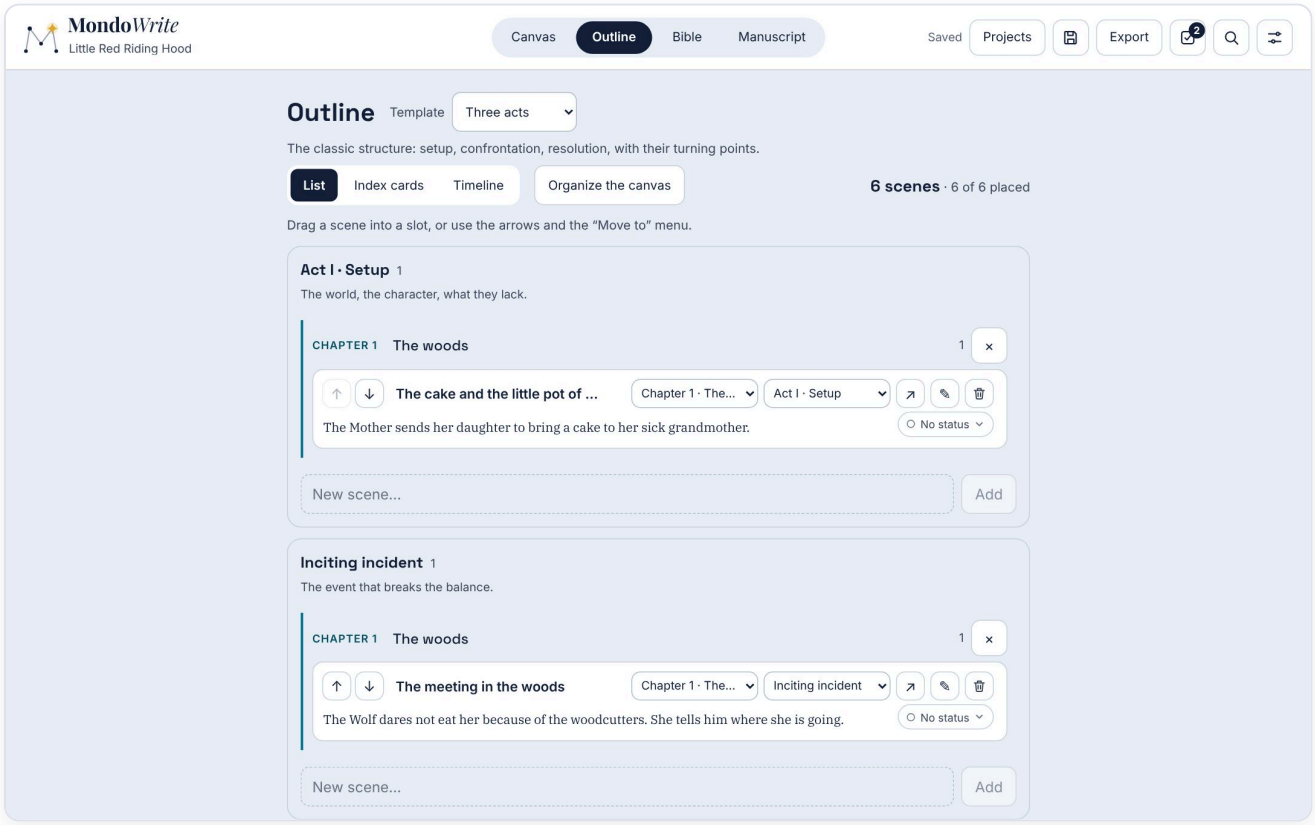
The Save the Cat template, its beats and their hints.

Arrange scenes

In the **List** layout, each scene shows its title, synopsis, status and chapter. To move it:

- drag it into another beat or to another place;
- or use its arrows, or the **Move to** menu.

Scenes not yet placed wait in **To place**, in canvas order. **New scene…** at the bottom of each beat creates a scene right there (and its card on the canvas). The arrow button (↗) shows the card on the canvas, the pencil (✎) opens the scene in the Manuscript, the trash button deletes it.



The three-act outline, as a list, with chapters.

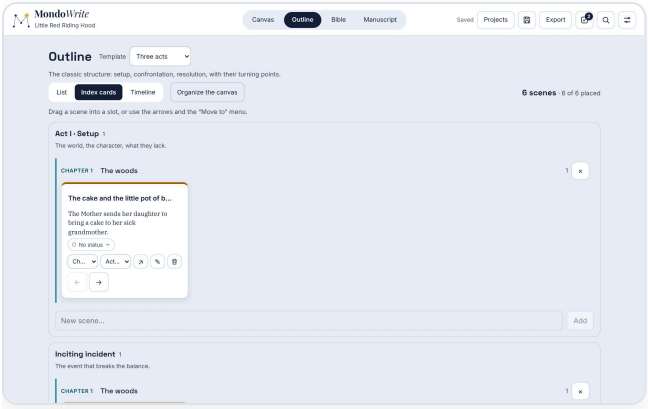
Chapters

Chapters divide the story. A scene's **Chapter** menu offers **New chapter from here**; each chapter may have a title (optional). Chapters are numbered automatically, from their place. Deleting a chapter gives its scenes back to the previous chapter: no scene is deleted. In the Manuscript, you can also start a chapter from the keyboard (see below).

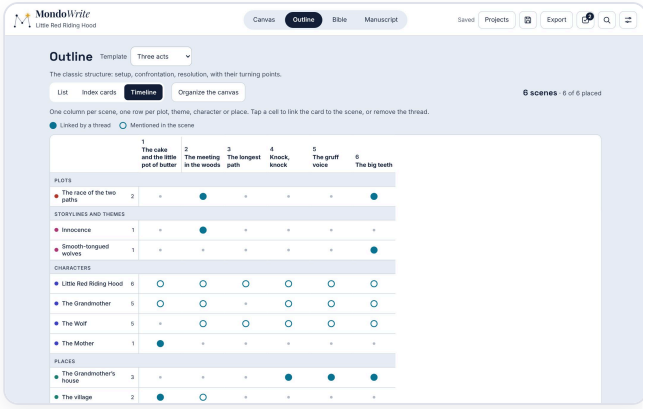
List, index cards, timeline

Three layouts of the same outline:

- **List**, to read and reorder;
- **Index cards**, like cards spread on a table;
- **Timeline**: one column per scene, one row per plot, theme, character and place. A filled dot means a thread between the card and the scene, a hollow dot that the scene names it in its text. Tap a cell to draw or remove the thread. The column of cards stays frozen on the left while the scenes scroll beneath it.



Index cards.



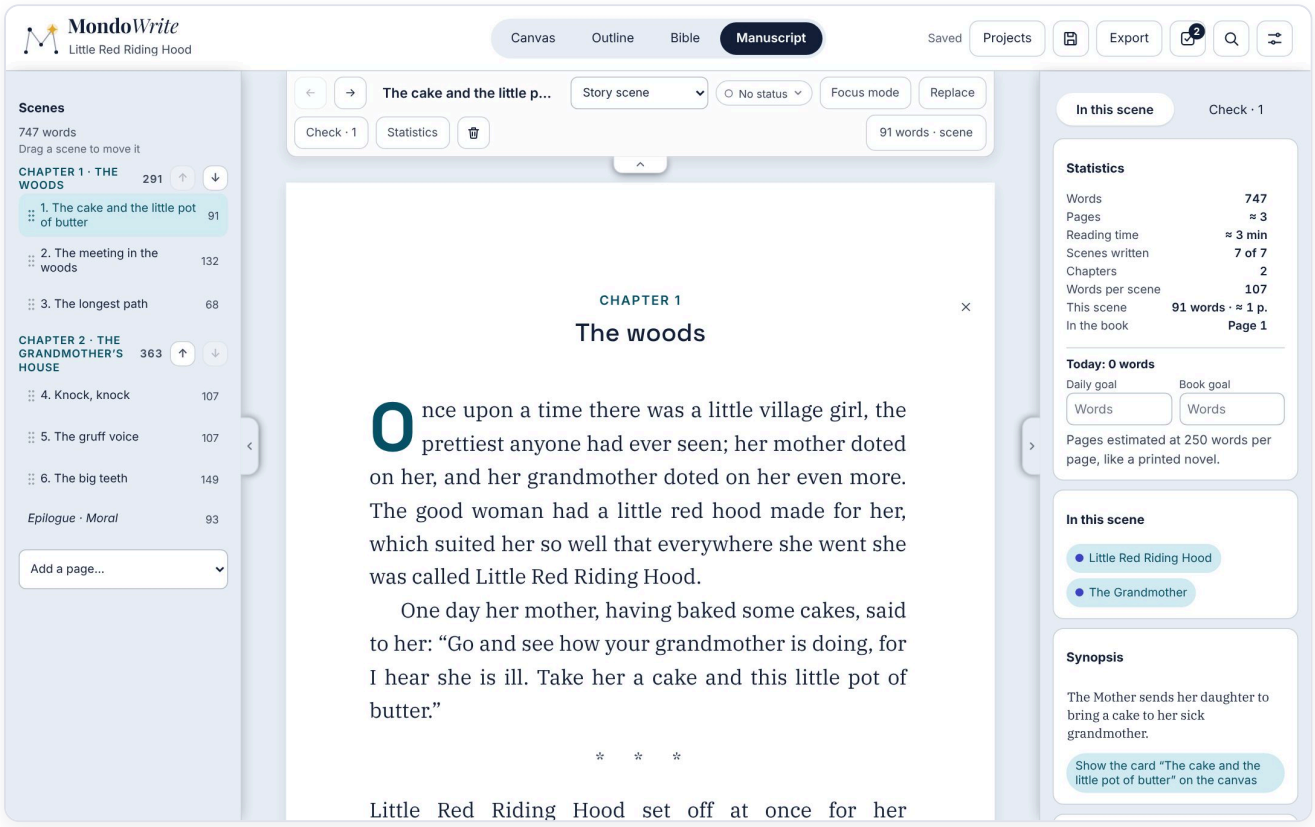
The timeline by plot.

Organize the canvas also arranges the canvas from the outline: one template beat, then one chapter, per frame.

CHAPTER 8

The Manuscript

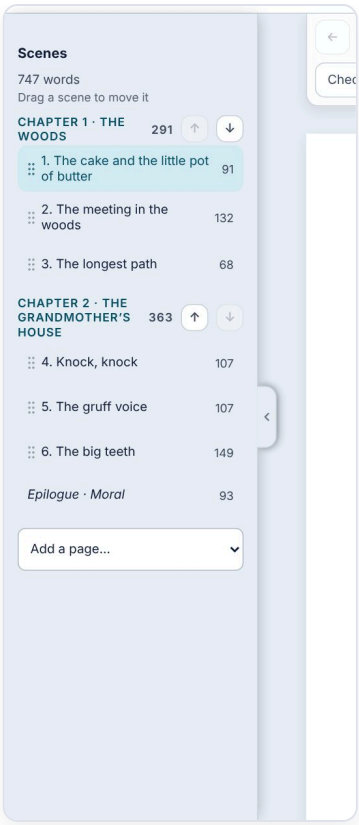
The Manuscript is where you write, one scene at a time, in outline order, on a page laid out like a book's.



The Manuscript view: scenes on the left, the page in the middle, statistics and the current scene on the right.

The scenes column

On the left, all the book's scenes, by chapter, with their word count. A click opens a scene. To move one, drag it (onto the top half of another scene to put it before, the bottom half to put it after), or use its arrows or **Alt** ↑ ↓. It takes the chapter and beat of its new neighbour. A whole chapter moves too, by dragging its title or with its arrows.



The scenes column.

The page

Above the page, a discreet bar: the scene arrows, the scene title, its page type, its status, and the **Graveyard**, **Focus mode**, **Replace** and trash buttons. The chapter number and title sit in the top margin; the first letter of a chapter becomes a drop cap when you are not writing in that paragraph. The scene's synopsis shows as a watermark in a scene that is still empty, like an outline note.

Page zoom. Ctrl + and Ctrl – enlarge or shrink the whole page, without changing its layout or page breaks; Ctrl 0 returns to normal size. The setting is also in **Settings** (**Page zoom**) and, on Mac, in the **View** menu. It also applies to the Screenplay sheet. Enlarged beyond the window, the page scrolls sideways.

Split a scene, start a chapter

You can divide the story without leaving the keyboard:

- Enter twice (on an empty line) splits the scene: a new scene is born, the rest of the text moves into it, and its card appears on the canvas just below the previous one;
- Enter three times starts a new chapter;
- Backspace in the newly born, still empty scene undoes the split.

An **Undo** message shows for ten seconds after each split.

Book pages

A published book also has pages outside the story. The **Add a page...** menu, below the scenes column, creates them: **Title page**, **Copyright**, **Dedication**, **Epigraph**, **Prologue**, **Epilogue**, **Acknowledgments**, **About the author**. They place themselves at the start or end of the book and are each laid out in their own way (a centred

italic dedication, a copyright page in small print…). The page type menu, in the bar, turns a scene into a book page and back.

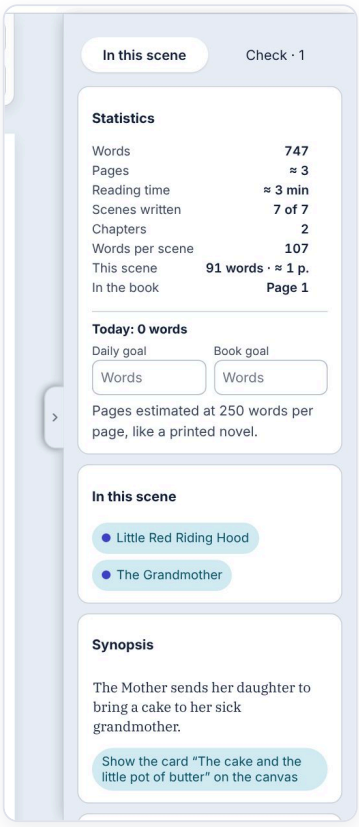
Scene status

Each scene has a status: **Draft**, **To revise** or **Done**. You choose it wherever you see the scene (the Manuscript bar, the card, the Bible, the Outline), and a coloured dot recalls it in lists. The statistics count finished scenes.

Statistics and goals

The right column shows the book's **statistics**: words, pages (estimated at 250 words a page, like a printed novel), reading time, scenes written, chapters, words per scene, and for the current scene its word count and place in the book. Set a **Daily goal** and a **Book goal** in words: today's progress, the number of days in a row and the book's progress are shown.

Below, **In this scene** lists the characters and places mentioned in the text (a click shows their card), then the scene's **Synopsis**, editable in place.



Statistics, goals, "In this scene" and synopsis.

Create a card as you write: /Name

To create a character or a place without leaving your sentence, type `/` followed by the name, anywhere in the text (after a space, a parenthesis or a quote): "/Lighthouse of Pious Wishes" accepts names of several words. The menu offers **Character** or **Place**; the card is created in the background, the name stays ordinary text (no link is left in the manuscript) and you keep typing. You fill in the card later in the Bible.

Another way: select a name you have already written and type `/`, or tap the **Character** or **Place** button in the small bar that appears on the selection.

The Graveyard

A passage you are unsure about does not have to be deleted. Select it and press Ctrl Shift K (or, on a touch screen, tap the Graveyard button in the selection bar): it leaves the text and joins the **Graveyard** in the right column, with the scene it came from. **Put back** returns it exactly where it was; if the text has changed since, it goes to the closest spot, and to the end of the current scene if the original scene no longer exists. The Graveyard is kept in the project. A passage must lie within a single scene.

The panels

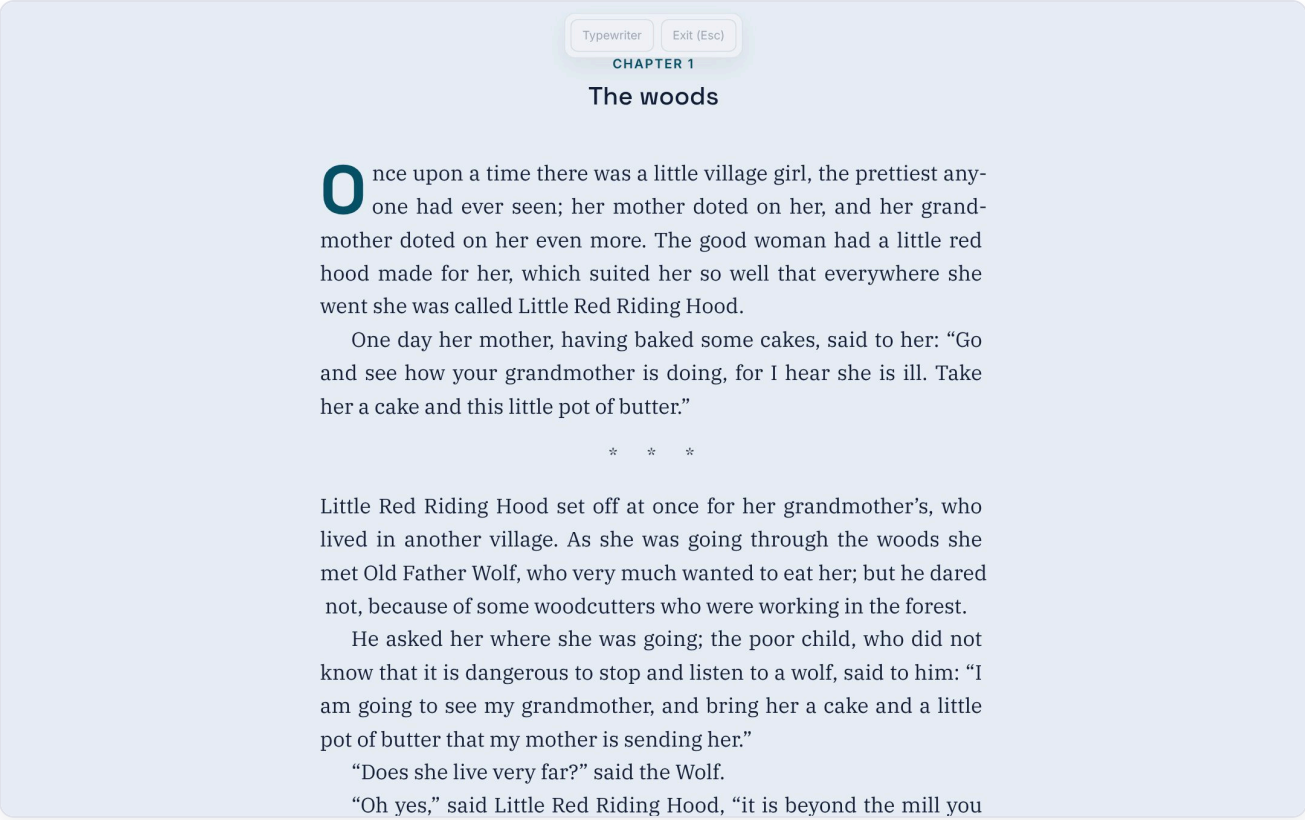
The scenes column and the right column fold away: a handle on the edge of the page opens and closes them, and MondoWrite remembers your choice. On a narrow screen (iPad upright, iPhone) they become drawers over the page, closed by default on a phone.

The spell checker

The system spell checker is set in Settings, **Spell checker**: **Except manuscript and screenplay** (the default: your scenes' text is not underlined while you write), **Everywhere** or **Nowhere**. On Mac, iPad and iPhone, the system underlines words as you type them or come back to them: text already written is not always checked in full as soon as it opens. Unchecking **Keyboard suggestions and autocorrect** stops the iPad, iPhone or Mac keyboard from suggesting words and correcting your text for you.

Focus mode

Focus mode (Ctrl Shift F) keeps only the page on screen. At the top, two settings: **Typewriter** keeps the current line in the middle of the screen, and **Highlight** fades everything except the current sentence, line or paragraph. Esc leaves it. The Screenplay has the same focus mode, with the same settings.



Focus mode.

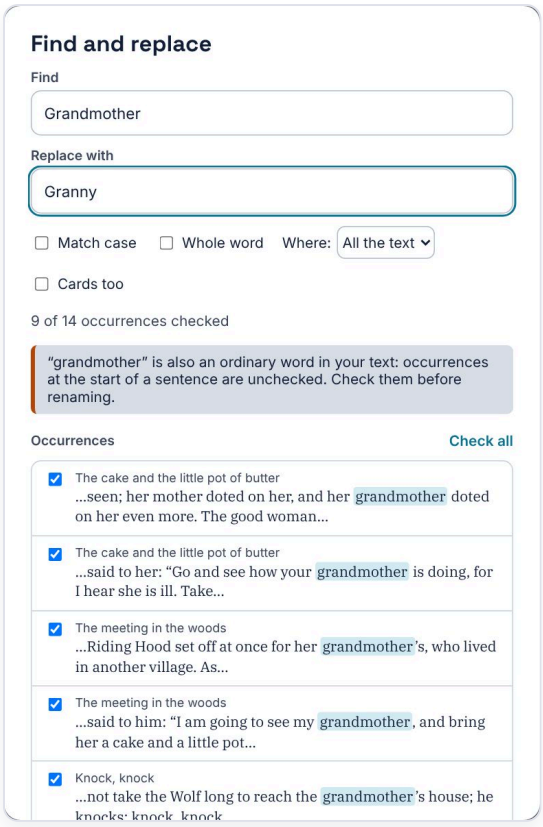
Typography as you type

As you write, MondoWrite sets the right typography: curly quotes “ ”, apostrophe ’, ellipsis …, dash from two hyphens, and in French « » with their non-breaking spaces. The **Typography as you type** setting chooses: follow the language, French, English or none.

Find and replace

Replace (Ctrl Shift H) searches the whole text or the current scene, with or without the cards. **Match case** and **Whole word** refine the search; the number of matches shows as you type. The replaced word keeps its capitals. **Undo** puts everything back. @ mentions are never touched: they already follow their card. Each match is listed with the sentence around it: uncheck the ones to leave as they are.

Rename everywhere… (a card’s ⋯ menu) only replaces the name as you wrote it, or in capitals: a character called Rose never changes “the sun rose”. If the name is also an ordinary word in your text (Will, Hope, Grace…), MondoWrite says so and unchecks the matches at the start of a sentence, where the word and the name look the same: read them before renaming.



Find and replace.

Check the text

The **Check** button in the bar (with the number of items found) opens the tab of the same name in the right column, next to **In this scene**. It points out what deserves a look, without ever correcting anything: a name spelled almost like an entry's ("Inés" for "Inès"), two spaces in a row, a space before a comma or a period. Touch an item to go to the passage, selected in the text. **Rename everywhere...** opens "Find and replace" with the right name; **Ignore** removes the item from the list until the app is closed.

It also asks questions about the story, never errors: the character marked as main is not the one seen in the most scenes ("Who do we really follow?"); a main character has not filled in their "Wants" box; a series has no episode yet; a secret has no planned reveal, or comes out with no clue planted before; an object is named in only one scene (set up without paying off, or paying off without being set up). Touch the question to open the profile; **It's intended** sets it aside.

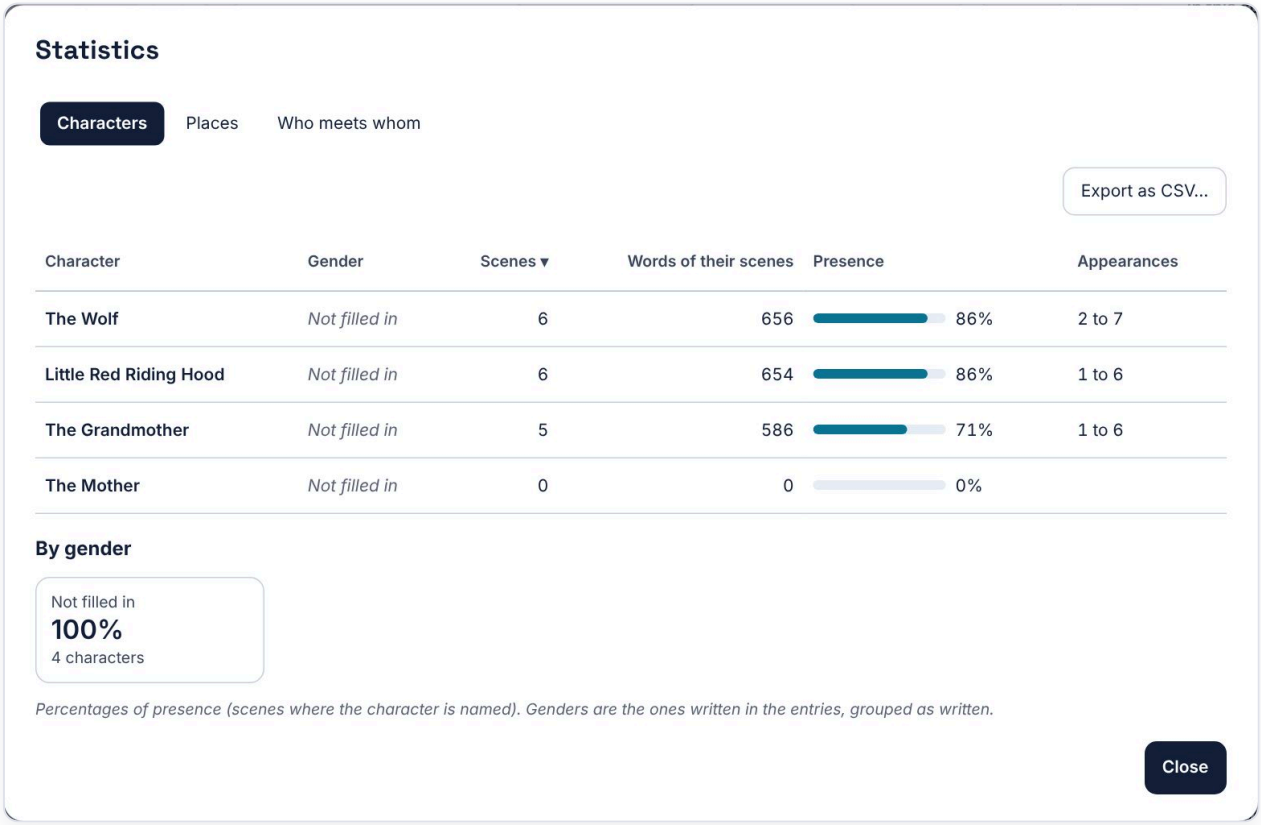
Project statistics

The **Statistics** button in the bar (also in the Screenplay's bar, and in the Mac **View** menu) opens a window that counts, in your text, what you can't see while writing. Nothing is typed in or saved there.

- **Characters**: for each one, their scenes, lines and words spoken (screenplay), their share of speaking time (or their **Presence** in a novel, the scenes where the text names them) and their appearances, from first to last scene. Touch a column title to sort, a name to open their entry. Below, **By gender** groups the values of the entries' "Gender" field as you wrote them.
- **Places** (**Locations** in a screenplay): for each place, its scenes, its share of the story, its appearances and the characters met there. In a novel, a scene takes place somewhere when a thread links it to that place on the canvas, or when its text names it.

- **Who meets whom**: a table of the scenes each pair of characters shares (they speak or are named in them). Touch a cell to list their shared scenes and open one. Beside it, the most present pair and the characters who never meet: nothing wrong in itself, it’s a question to ask yourself.

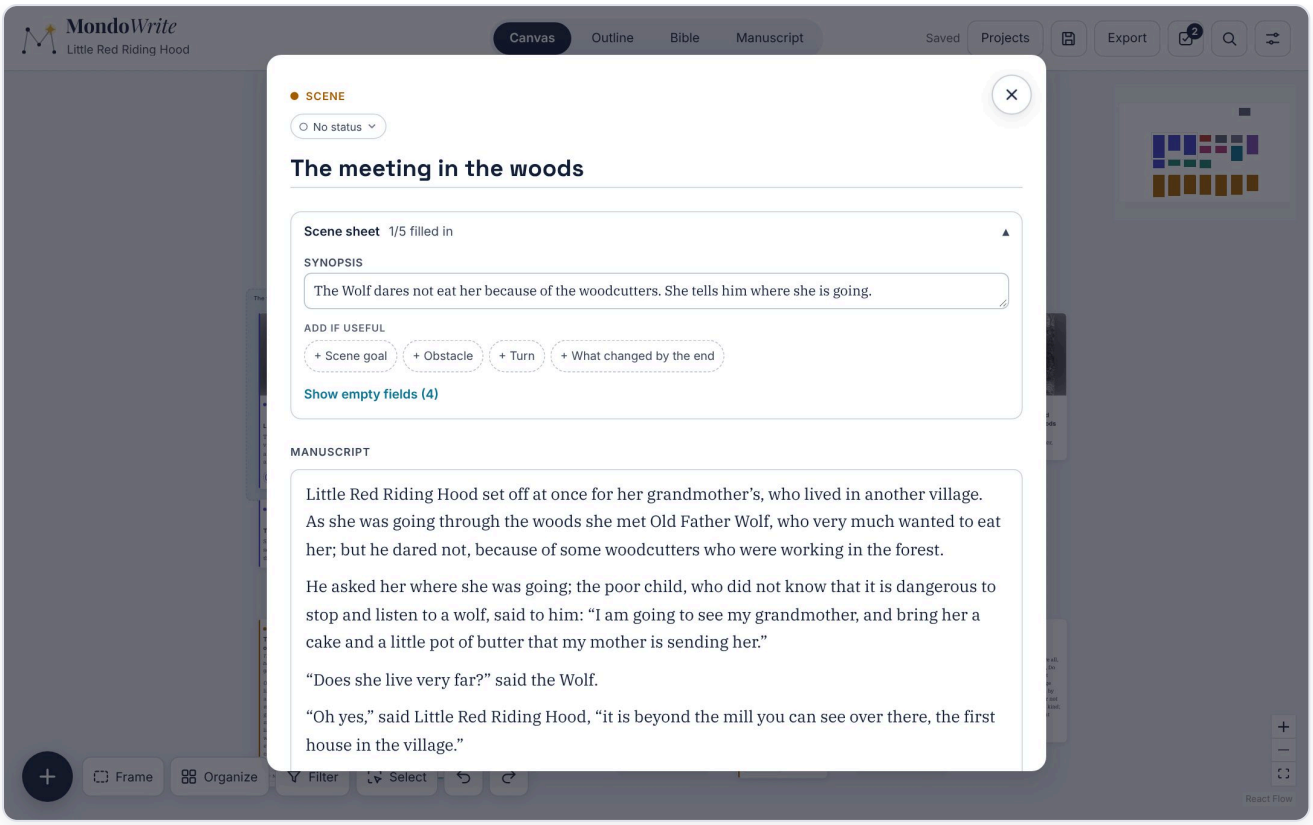
Each tab has its **Export as CSV...**, for a spreadsheet.



The Statistics window, Characters tab, on the tale.

Write from the card

A Scene card carries its text. On the canvas, it shows its synopsis, the start of its scene and its word count. Expanded, it becomes a page where you write the scene, the same as in the Manuscript; **Open in Manuscript** takes you there.



The scene "The meeting in the woods" written in its expanded card.

Texts without a card

Deleting a Scene card never deletes its text. If a scene has lost its card, it appears in **Texts without a card**, at the bottom of the column: **Recreate the card** puts it back in the book.

CHAPTER 9

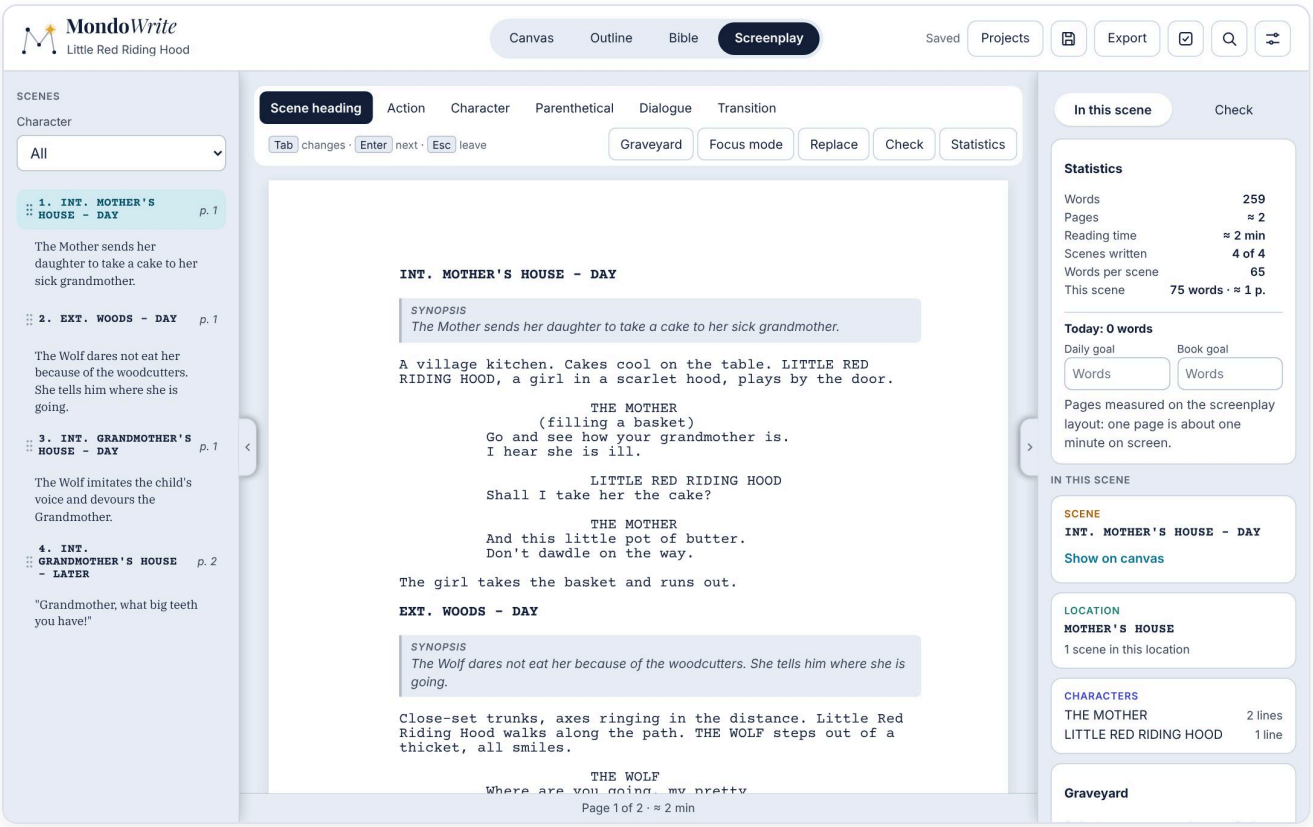
The Screenplay

In a screenplay project, the Manuscript becomes the **Screenplay** view: an editor in standard film format, which saves the text as Fountain, an open format read by Highland, Fade In, WriterSolo, Slugline or Trelby. The **Outline** lists the scenes in screenplay order.

Switch to screenplay

Create a project with **A screenplay**, import a Fountain or Final Draft file, or switch an existing project in **Settings** › **This project** › **Project type**. The vocabulary follows: Places are called Locations, a Scene card's title is its heading ("INT. LIGHTHOUSE - NIGHT"), and length is counted in pages and minutes (one page is about one minute), shown in the top bar.

The editor



The Screenplay view: scenes on the left, the page in the middle, "In this scene" on the right.

The screenplay is made of **elements**: **Scene heading**, **Action**, **Character**, **Parenthetical**, **Dialogue**, **Transition**. The bar above the page shows the current element and lets you change it with a click. From the keyboard:

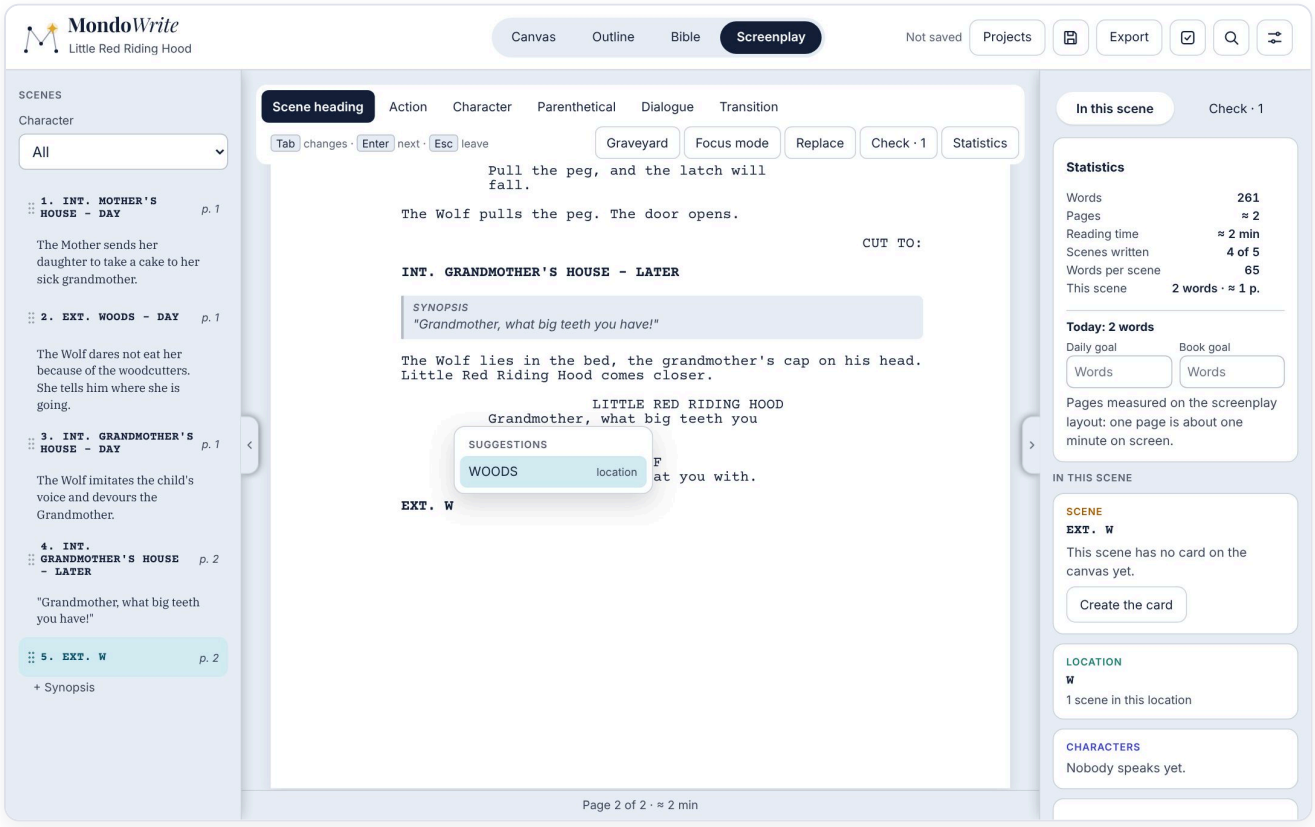
- **Tab** changes the element type (**Shift** **Tab** the other way);
- **Enter** moves to the next logical element: character then dialogue, dialogue then action…;
- **Esc** leaves the page and hands over to the element bar.

On iPhone, the bar is folded at the top of the page: it only shows the type of the current element. Tap it to open the panel (the six elements, then **Graveyard**, **Focus mode**, **Replace** and **Check**); it closes as soon as you pick an element. The **Statistics** window, too wide for a phone, isn't offered there: open it on iPad or a computer.

The app recognises what you type: a line starting with "int." or "ext." becomes a heading, a parenthesis under a character a parenthetical. The element you are writing switches to capitals when needed. The page is cut into real pages (Letter or A4), with the page number and length at the bottom.

Autocomplete

While you write a heading or a character name, MondoWrite suggests the locations and characters from the Bible, times of day (DAY, NIGHT…), extensions (V.O., O.S., CONT'D). Choose with the arrows and **Enter**. A new name offers to create its entry or location.



Autocomplete suggests the "Woods" location from the Bible.

A scene or a character written in the screenplay gets its card on the canvas (with the location's card and the "takes place in" thread), without anything being copied.

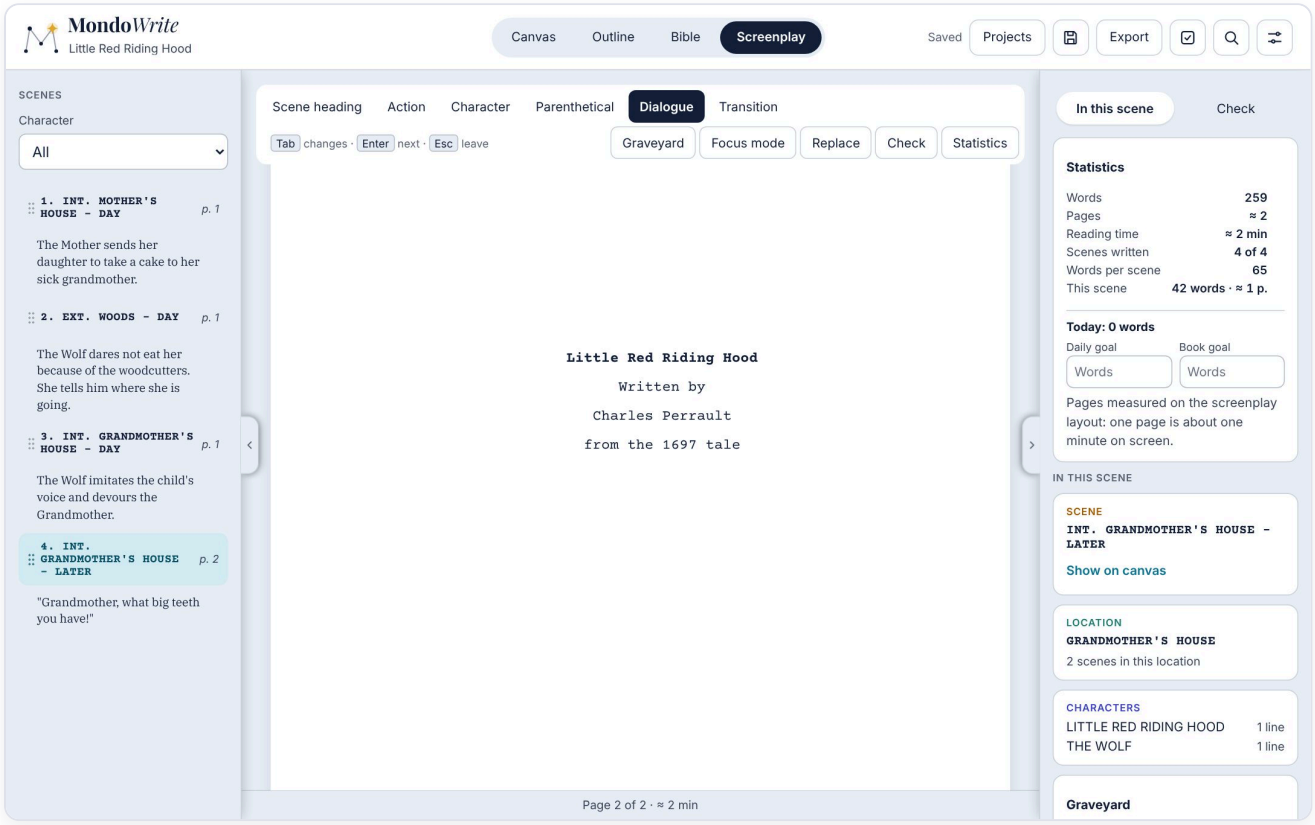
The scenes column and "In this scene"

On the left, the list of scenes with their synopsis and page; a click takes you there. They reorder by dragging their grip (⋮⋮ at the left of each scene), with their arrows or **Alt** ↑ ↓. **+ Synopsis** adds a synopsis to the scene (a Fountain `= …` line, ignored when printing). On the right, **In this scene** shows the scene's card, its location (with the number of scenes set there) and the characters who speak, with their number of lines. Both columns fold away with the handles on the edges of the page, as in the Manuscript (and become drawers on a narrow screen).

Title page and options

At the top of the page, the title page is filled in place: title, credit (“Written by”), author, source, contact, draft date. Your profile’s name is put there for every new screenplay.

Scene numbering and heading underlining (on screen, in the PDF and in the Final Draft export), as well as the page size (US Letter or A4), are set in **Settings** › **This project**. In the bar, **Graveyard**, **Focus mode** and **Replace** work as in the Manuscript.



The screenplay’s title page.

Statistics, Graveyard and focus mode

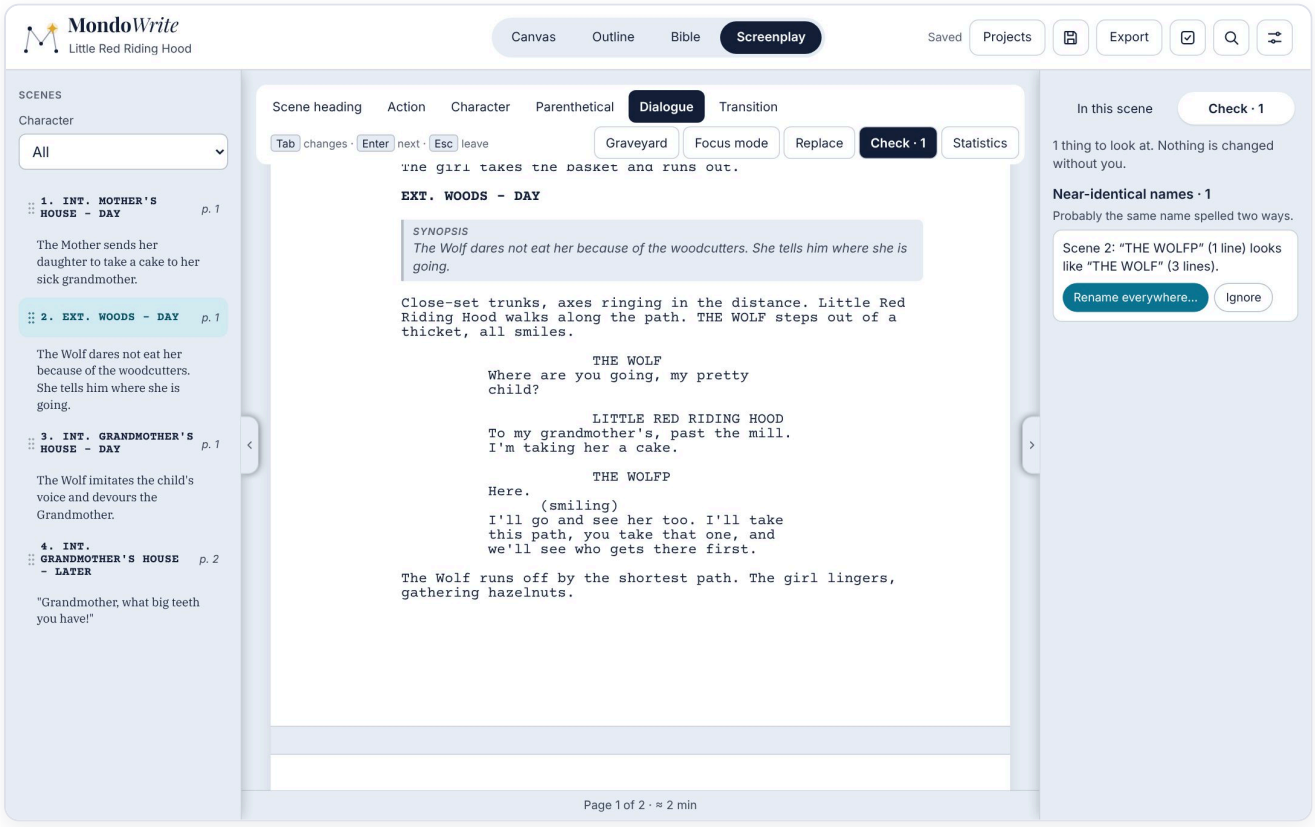
The right column starts with the screenplay’s **statistics**: words, pages (measured on the screenplay layout), running time, scenes written, and the daily and project goals. Words written in the screenplay count toward today’s progress and the days in a row, as in the Manuscript. Below, **In this scene**, then the **Graveyard**: select a passage and press Ctrl Shift K to set it aside, **Put back** brings it back.

Focus mode keeps only the text, without page breaks: **Typewriter** keeps the current line at the same height, and the highlight chosen in Settings (sentence, line or paragraph) fades the rest. Esc leaves it.

Check the screenplay

As in the Manuscript, **Check** opens a tab of things to look at: near-identical character names (“CHAPPERON” next to “CHAPERON”, with each one’s number of lines), a character who speaks without a card (**Create the card**; a typo on a known name is listed among the near-identical names, with **Rename everywhere…**), action longer than 4 lines, a heading without INT./EXT. or without a time, a character with no line, extra spaces, and the questions about the story (main character, “Wants” box, series without episodes, with **New episode**,

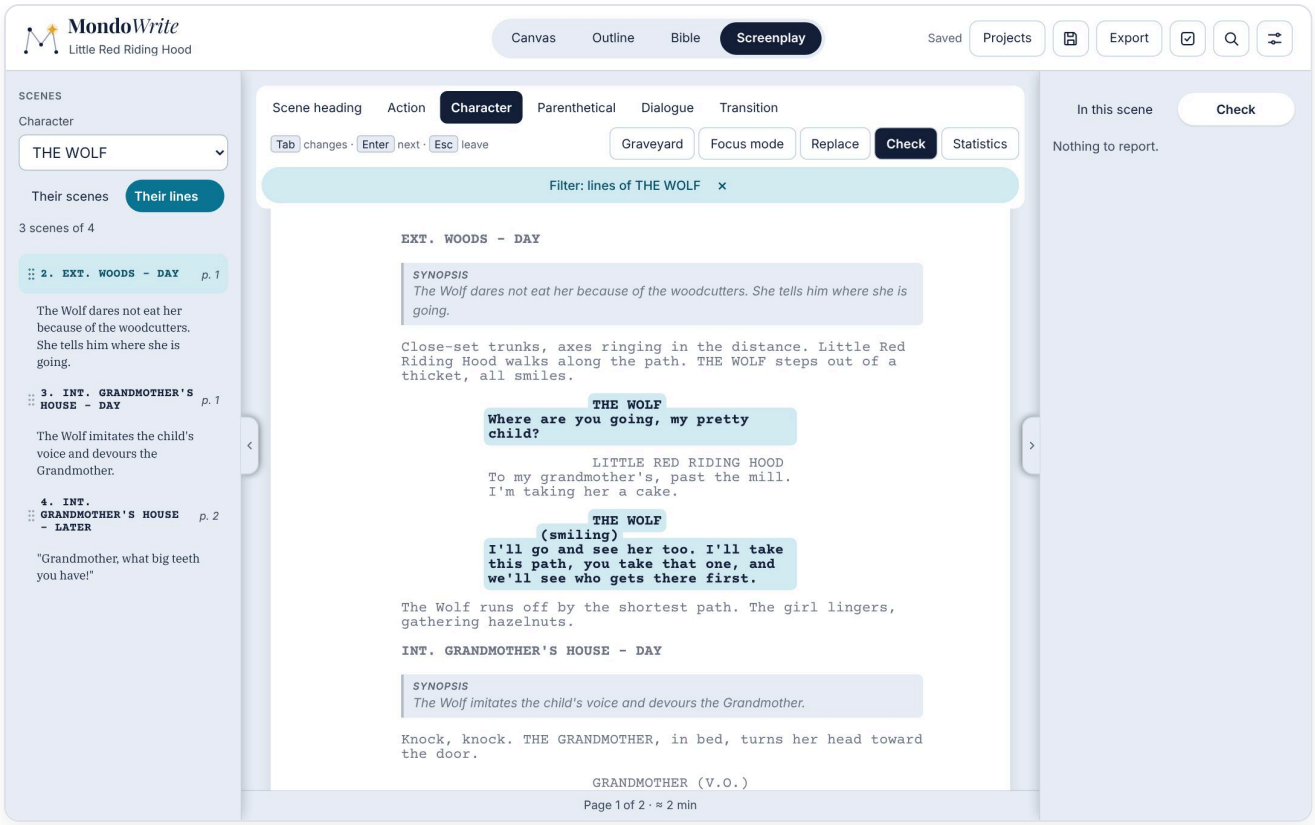
secrets, objects, and the length of the pilot: about one page per minute, from the format chosen on the cover, for example 27 to 35 pages for 30-minute episodes). Touch an item to go to the element; nothing changes without you.



The screenplay's "Check" tab.

Filter by character

At the top of the scene list, choose a **Character**: **Their scenes** keeps only the scenes where they speak or are named in the action; **Their lines** also fades everything they don't say. The faded text stays editable, and the sheet becomes continuous while the filter is on. The banner in the bar, or **All**, brings back the whole screenplay. From their entry in the Bible, **See their lines in the screenplay** sets this filter directly.



The Wolf's lines, the rest faded.

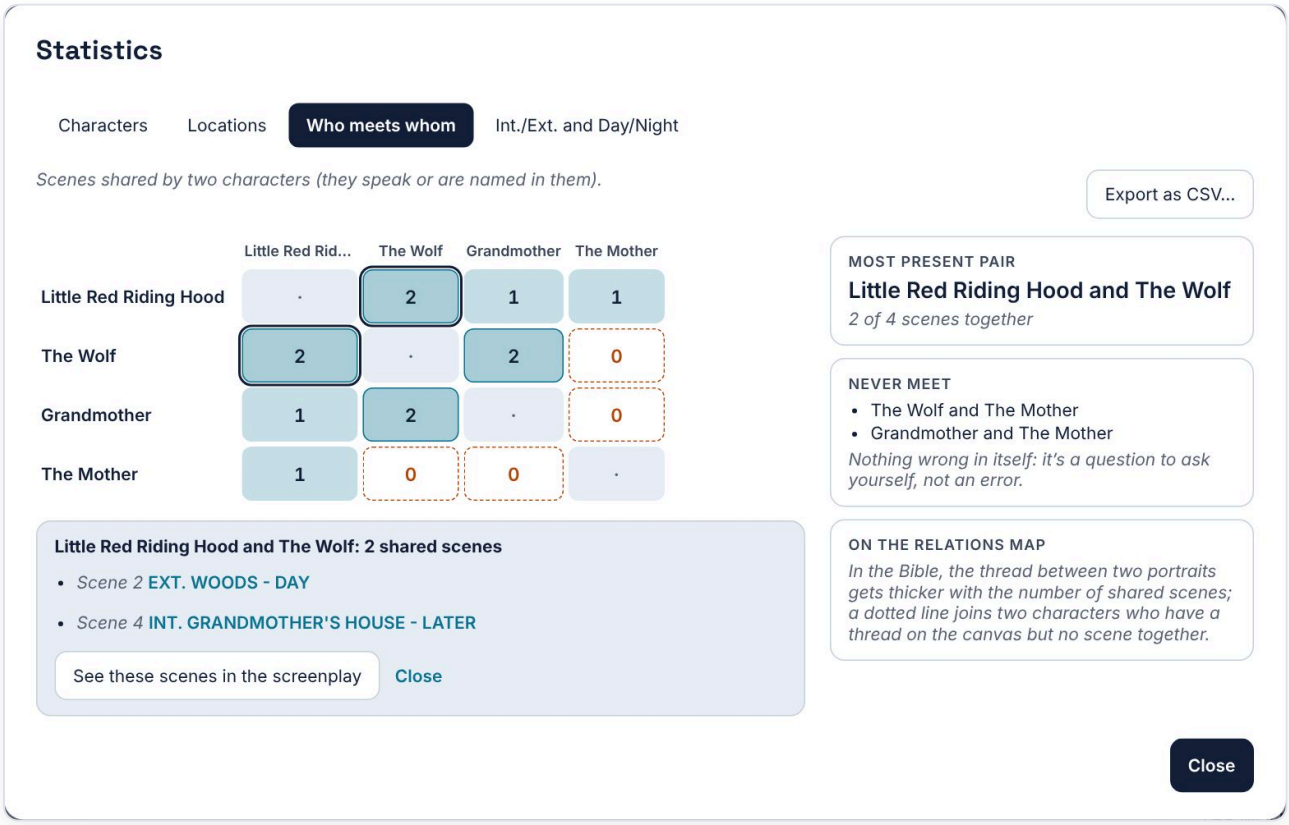
Screenplay statistics

The **Statistics** button in the bar opens the same window as in a novel (see "Project statistics"), read from the screenplay. The **Locations** tab is a shooting breakdown: the pages of each location (one page is about one minute), its interior or exterior scenes, day or night, and the characters met there. You see at a glance what will be expensive (exterior nights) or a location used only once. A location written without a card gets its own row.



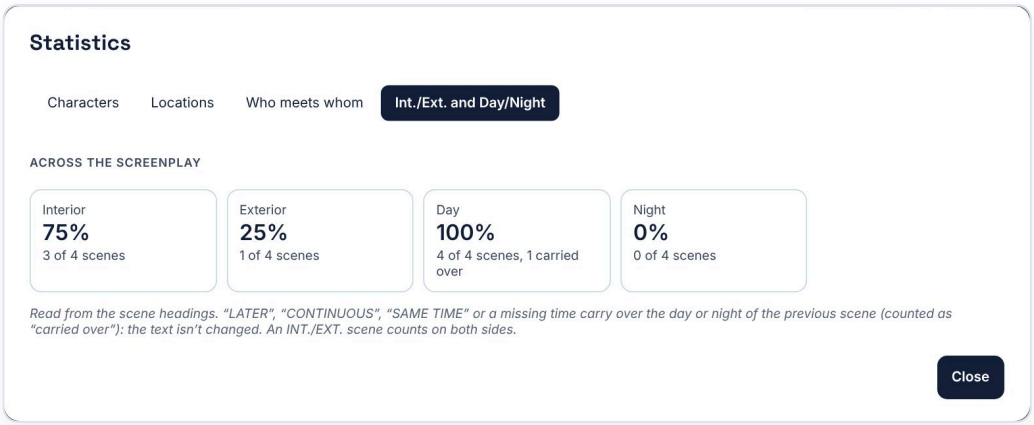
The locations of the tale as a screenplay.

In **Who meets whom**, a touched cell also offers **See these scenes in the screenplay**: the filter then keeps only the scenes where both characters meet.



The Wolf and Little Red Riding Hood share two scenes.

The **Int./Ext. and Day/Night** tab counts across the whole screenplay. A “LATER”, “CONTINUOUS” or “SAME TIME” scene, or one with no time, carries over the day or night of the previous scene: it is counted as “carried over”, without touching the text. An INT./EXT. scene counts on both sides.

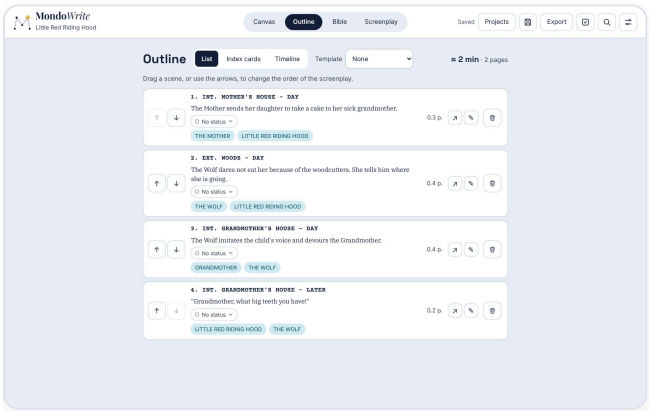


Interior or exterior, day or night, across the screenplay.

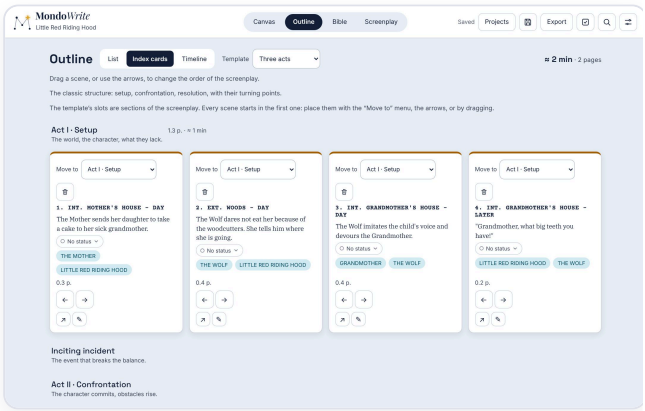
The outline of a screenplay

The outline lists the scenes in screenplay order, with their synopsis, characters, length and status. Drag a scene or use its arrows to change the order of the screenplay itself. On each scene, ↗ shows its card on the canvas and ✎ opens it in the Screenplay.

The **Template** menu offers: none, three acts, Save the Cat, eight sequences (the film in eight sequences of about fifteen minutes) and TV episode (teaser, four acts, tag). The template's beats are sections of the Fountain file, which other software sees as plain sections; place scenes with **Move to**, the arrows or by dragging. Each beat shows its hint and its length.



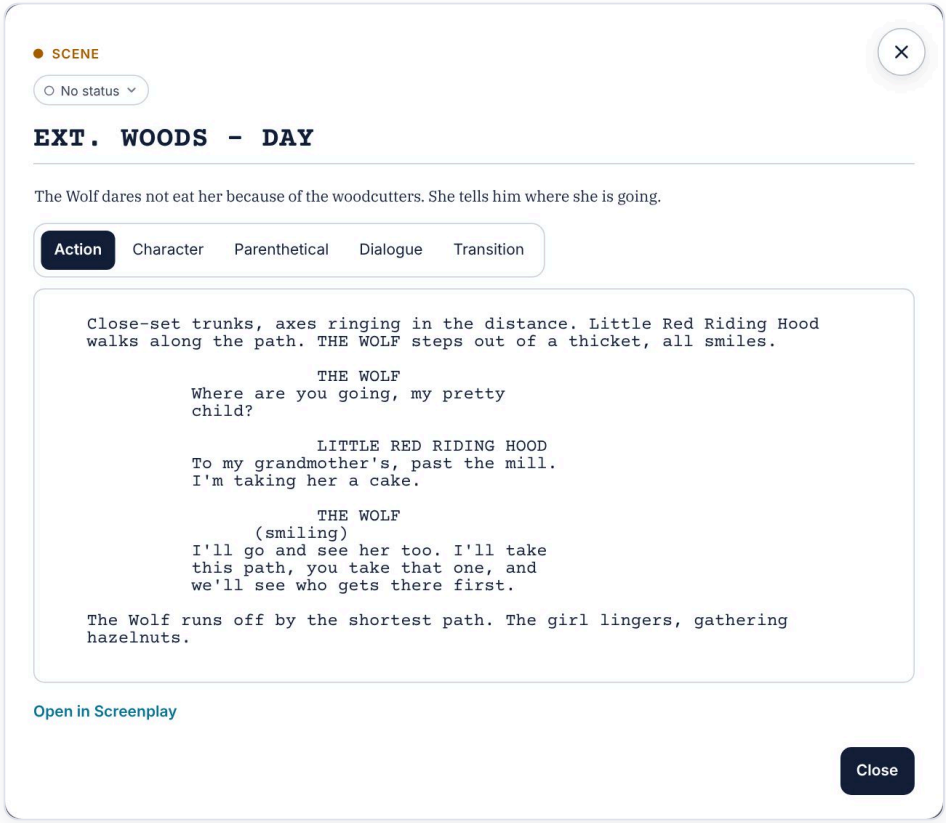
The outline of a screenplay, as a list.



As index cards, with the three-act template.

A scene in its card

Expanded, a screenplay Scene card shows its heading, its synopsis and an editor limited to the text of that scene, with the same element bar.



The scene "EXT. WOODS - DAY" written in its card.

CHAPTER 10

AI, optional

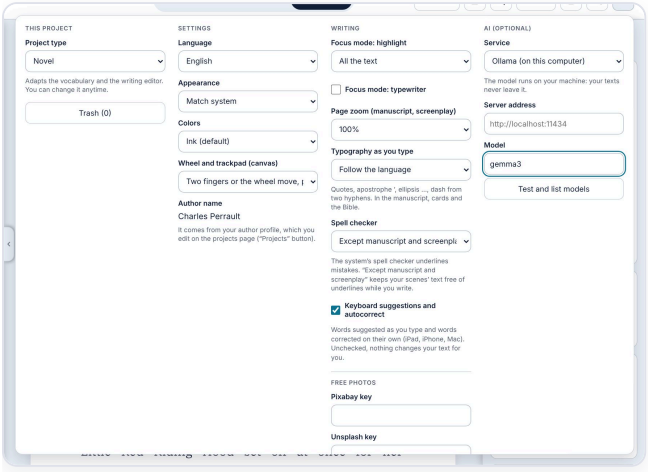
MondoWrite works entirely without AI. If you plug one in, it asks questions and makes suggestions; it never writes your text, and nothing changes without your say.

Plug in a service

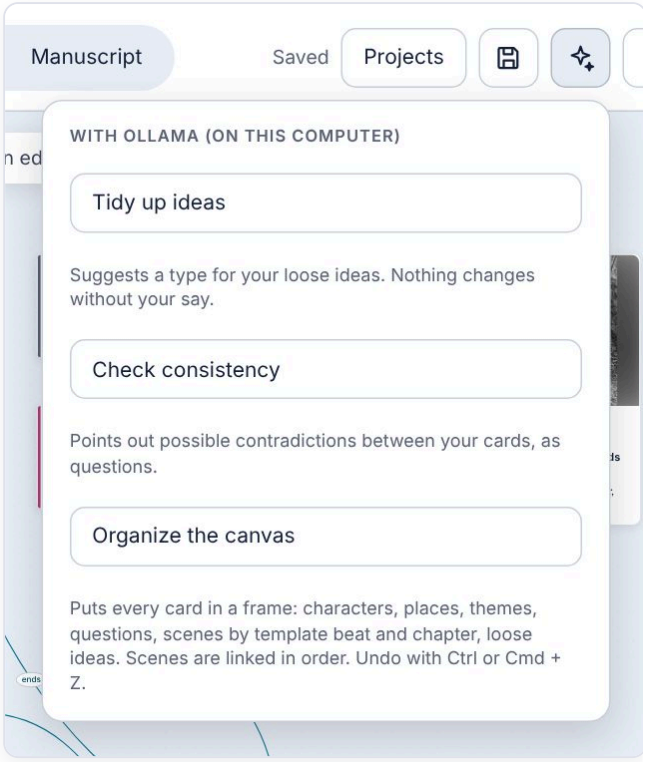
In **Settings** › **AI (optional)**, choose a **Service**:

- **Claude (Anthropic), OpenAI, OpenRouter**: online services. Paste your **API key**; it stays on your device, never in the project. Your cards are only sent to the service when you run an AI action.
- **Ollama, LM Studio**: models running on your computer. Your texts never leave it. Give the server address (the default one usually works).

Test and list models checks the connection and offers the list of available models. The **AI** button then appears in the top bar.



Plugging in Ollama in Settings.



The AI menu.

What the AI can do

- **Tidy up ideas**: suggests a type for each of your loose ideas (“this one is a character”, “this one a place”), with its reason. Apply or ignore each suggestion, or **Apply all**; everything can be undone on the canvas.
- **Check consistency**: points out possible contradictions between your cards, as questions. A question can become a Question card.

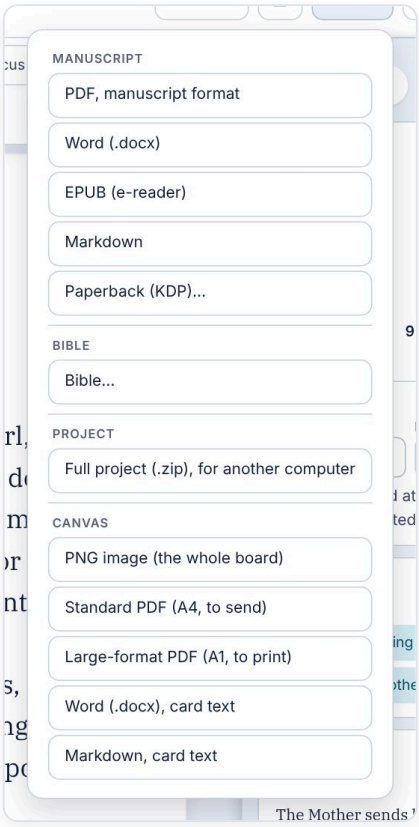
- **Tailored questions**: in a character's assistant, **Tailored** asks for a question written from their entry. You answer.
- **Summary**: **AI summary** puts in order what you wrote about a character (sheet, notes, answers), inventing nothing; it only goes into the entry when you click.
- **Describe a photo**: enlarge a photo in the gallery, then **Describe with AI**. For a place, the AI notes what the photo shows; for a character, it suggests the apparent age and appearance, which you accept field by field. It never tries to identify a person. The model must be able to read images.

The AI always names cards by their title. When something goes wrong, a message says what: service unreachable, key rejected, unknown model, limit reached.

CHAPTER 11

Export and publish

The **Export** button makes your files inside the app, with no external tool. Choose the format: the file is saved wherever you decide.



The Export menu of a novel.

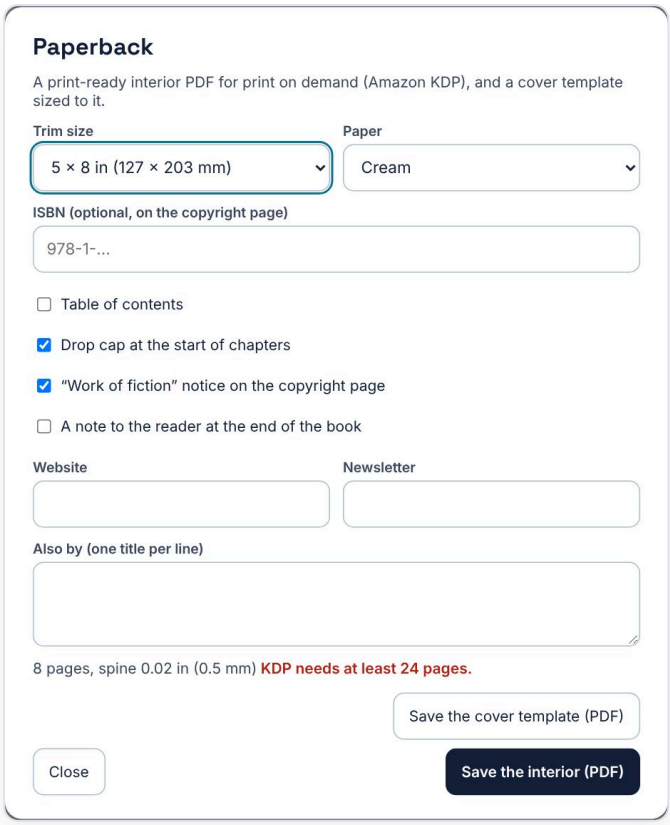
The manuscript

- **PDF, manuscript format**: the format agents and editors expect (known as “Shunn”): Courier 12, double spacing, indents, your contact details at the top left of the cover page, the rounded word count on the right, the title in the middle and “by” your name. Each page has the header “Name / TITLE / page”, each chapter starts on a new page, and a “#” separates two scenes. The PDF has a bookmark per chapter.
- **Word (.docx)**, to rework or send;
- **EPUB (e-reader)**, with its table of contents;
- **Markdown**, a single text file.

Scenes of the same chapter form one chapter, separated by “* * *”. Book pages (dedication, prologue…) are in their place.

The paperback (KDP)

Paperback (KDP)… prepares your book for print on demand (Amazon KDP): a print-ready interior PDF, and a cover template sized to it.



The "Paperback" window.

Settings

- **Trim size**: 5 × 8, 5.25 × 8, 5.5 × 8.5 or 6 × 9 inches. The type size and margins follow the trim.
- **Paper**: white, cream or groundwood. It sets the spine thickness.
- **ISBN** (optional), printed on the copyright page.
- **Table of contents**, **Drop cap at the start of chapters**, the **"Work of fiction"** notice, **A note to the reader at the end of the book** ("Thank You for Reading", with your **Website** and **Newsletter**), and the **Also by** list.

The settings are kept with the project. As soon as the window opens, and at each change, the book is laid out: the window shows the page count and spine width, and warns if KDP would refuse the book (fewer than 24 pages, or too many pages for this paper).

What the interior contains

- A real book layout: mirror margins, with a gutter (the margin on the binding side) that grows with the page count, as KDP requires;
- the title page, the copyright page on its back (yours if you wrote the "Copyright" page, otherwise a default page: copyright, all rights reserved, fiction notice, ISBN), the dedication and epigraph on right-hand pages, the table of contents with page numbers;
- each chapter on a right-hand page, page 1 at the start of the story, running heads (your name on left-hand pages, the title on right-hand ones) and page numbers at the outside corners;
- justified text, hyphenated according to the language (English or French), with no stray line at the top or bottom of a page, in Crimson Text with its italic;
- the back pages: note to the reader, acknowledgments, about the author, "Also by"; an even page count; a bookmark per chapter.

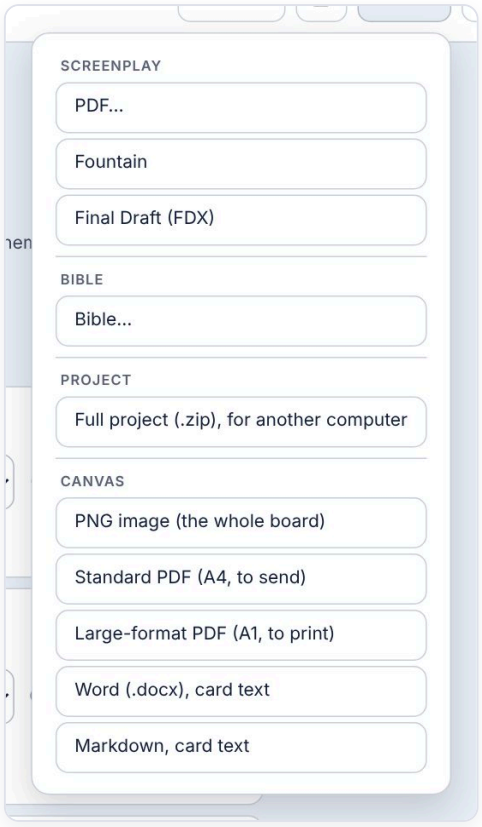
The cover template

Save the cover template (PDF) gives a page at the exact size of your full cover (back, spine, front), bleed included: the spine computed from the page count and paper, the safe areas to keep text inside, the area for the barcode KDP adds, and the measurements written on it. Use it as a guide layer in your design software, then hide it before exporting your cover. Under 79 pages, KDP doesn't accept text on the spine.

> **ADVICE**
> Fill in the "Title page", "Copyright", "Dedication" or "Acknowledgments" pages in the Manuscript so they replace the ones MondoWrite makes. Always check KDP's previewer before publishing.

The screenplay

- **PDF...**: the standard format (Courier 12, standard margins, about a page a minute, dialogue split cleanly across pages with "(MORE)" and "(CONT'D)", dual dialogue side by side), in a settings window described below;
- **Fountain**, the screenplay's text file;
- **Final Draft (FDX)**, for productions that use it.



The Export menu of a screenplay.

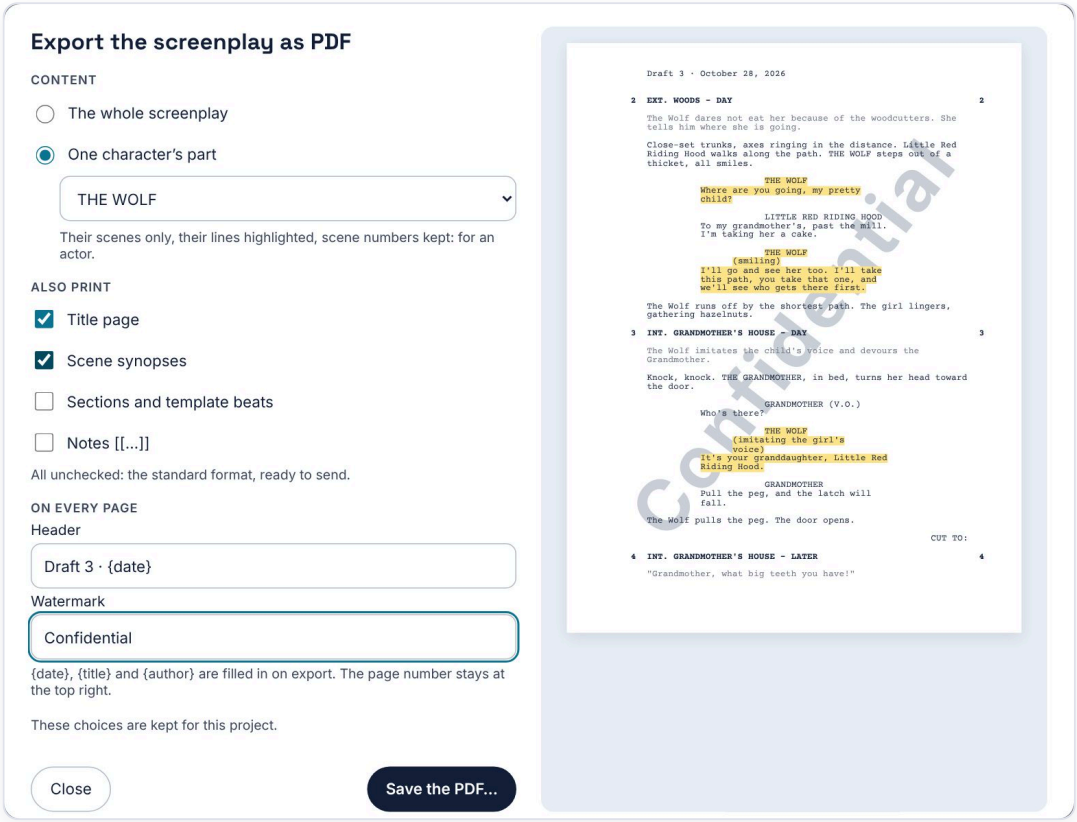
PDF settings

The **Export the screenplay as PDF** window shows the first page as it will come out, updated with every choice:

- **Content**: **The whole screenplay**, or **One character's part**. For an actor: only their scenes, their lines highlighted, and the scenes keep their number from the whole screenplay (to talk about "scene 12" with the crew).

- **Also print**: the title page, scene synopses, sections and template beats, your `[[…]]` notes, in gray. All unchecked (except the title page), it's the standard format, the one you send.
- **On every page**: a **Header** at the top left, where `{date}`, `{title}` and `{author}` are filled in on export ("Draft 3 · {date}"), and a **Watermark** across the page ("Confidential"). The page number stays at the top right.

These choices are kept in the project: next time, the window opens as you left it.



The Wolf's part, for the actor, with header and watermark.

The Bible

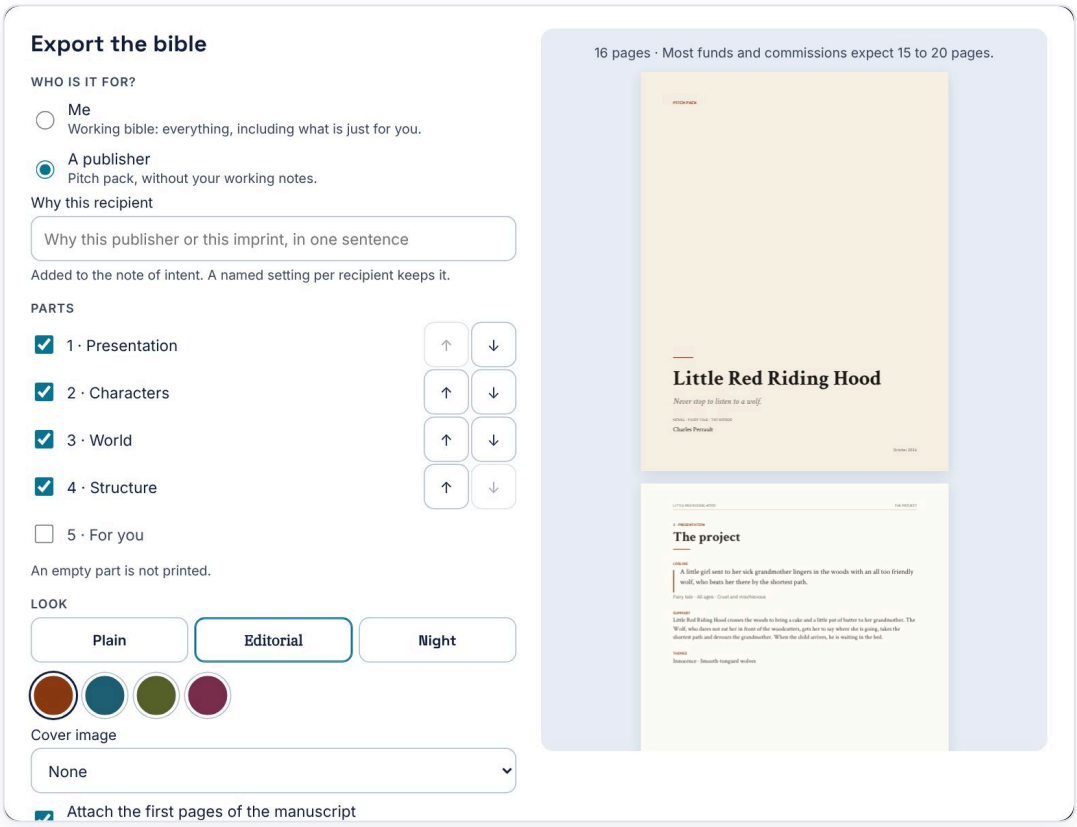
Bible… opens the **Export the bible** window. Three questions are enough, and the preview, on the right, shows the real PDF, page by page, rebuilt at every change.

- **Who is it for? Me** gives the **working bible**: everything, including the "For you" part. **A publisher** (novel) gives a **pitch pack**, **A producer** (screenplay) a **series bible**: without your working notes, with a page for each main character.
- **Parts**: tick the parts to print and order them with the arrows. An empty part is not printed; "For you" always comes last.
- **Look**: **Plain**, **Editorial** or **Night**, one colour out of four, a **Cover image** taken from your project, and the **Place photos as thumbnails**.

For someone else, the document stays short: above the preview, the page count is followed by a marker, "Most funds and commissions expect 15 to 20 pages", never by a block. **Why this recipient** adds a sentence at the end of the note of intent ("Why this network"): save one preset per recipient. Your background and your works (writer profile) make an "About the author" page at the end, preceded by "Why me" for a series. The characters' voice and writing notes stay in the working bible.

A series bible also gets the arena and what came before the pilot, what holds the characters together, the engine, the season's question and where it ends, the episodes (a short list: number, title, marker, synopsis, pivot character, grouped by season), the future seasons, the writing rules and, for someone else, the other platforms. Groups, objects, events and rules of the world follow the places in the World part; secrets follow the plots in the Structure. Two options, unchecked for a producer: **Thread grid** (which storylines in which episodes, or in which parts of the pilot if there are no episodes) and **"At a glance" page** (the characters' hooks and the episodes each appears in). **Attach the first pages of the pilot** adds the first ten pages of the screenplay at the end, in standard format. For a publisher, **Attach the first pages of the manuscript** does the same with your novel, in manuscript format. The look offered by default is Plain for a producer, Editorial for a publisher.

Your choices are kept with the project. **Preset** saves them under a name ("For my editor", "Writers' room") to find them again. The file carries today's date ("Pitch pack - Title - 2026-10-26"): each send keeps its version. **Word** and **Markdown** keep the chosen parts and their order, not the look.



The "Export the bible" window: a pitch pack in the Editorial look.

The canvas

The **canvas** exports to a PNG image of the whole board, a standard PDF (A4, to send) or a large-format one (A1, to print and pin on the wall), or as card text (Word, Markdown), one part per frame.

CHAPTER 12

Your files

A MondoWrite project is an ordinary folder, full of text files you can open, copy, back up or version as you like.

A project's folder

File or folder	Contents
`cosmos.json`	The title, type, card positions, threads, frames, outline, goals, project cover, paperback settings.
`cartes/`	One card per Markdown file, with a small header (type, title, image, sheet).
`manuscrit/`	The text of each scene of a novel, in Markdown.
`scenario.fountain`	The screenplay's text, in Fountain.
`medias/`	The cards' images and PDFs.
`corbeille/`	Deleted cards, waiting to be restored or erased.
`markdown/`	Readable copies of the manuscript, bible and canvas, with one version a day.

A mention of a card is written as an ordinary Markdown link: `[@The Wolf](cosmos:…)`. Everything stays readable in any text editor (the folder names are French, and "cosmos" comes from the app's former name).

Markdown copies and versions

After each save, the desktop app writes into `markdown/` the manuscript, the bible and the canvas in Markdown, with links between entries. A dated copy is kept every day in `markdown/versions/`: thirty days, then one per month. These copies are never read back: always write in the app. The **Markdown copies in the project folder** setting (**Settings** › **This project**) turns them off.

Syncing between devices

A project stays an ordinary folder: a sync service copies it from one device to another, and MondoWrite reloads the changes. Choose according to your devices:

Your devices	Recommended method
iPhone, iPad and Mac	iCloud Drive, on by default: nothing to set up.
With a Windows or Linux PC	A Dropbox folder chosen on each device.
One-off hand-over	A .zip file.

- **iCloud Drive (iPhone, iPad, Mac).** Projects are kept in the MondoWrite folder of iCloud Drive (`projets` subfolder). The **Settings** › **Sync projects with iCloud Drive** box is checked by default on iPhone and iPad,

and on the Mac as soon as iCloud Drive holds that folder. Projects created on one device show up by themselves on the projects page of the others, without looking for them. Each device must be signed in to the same iCloud account, with iCloud Drive turned on. Without iCloud Drive, projects stay on the device and Settings says so. If iCloud Drive is turned off later, the projects page warns that iCloud projects no longer show up: they aren't lost and come back when it is turned on again. On the Mac, if projects are slow to arrive, **Find the folder…** opens the MondoWrite iCloud folder: choose `projets` there. iCloud sometimes creates a duplicate "projets 2" when two devices create that folder at the same time: the projects page says so, and **Put them back with the others** moves its projects into `projets`.

- **A cloud folder (iPhone, iPad, PC, Mac).** On the projects page, **Choose a cloud folder…** remembers a synced folder. New projects are created in a subfolder named after their title, and the projects it holds show up in the list. Choose the same folder on each device. On iPhone and iPad the picker is the Files app. Only folders that hold a project show up in the list. **Stop syncing** (computer) or **Back to iCloud projects** (iPhone, iPad) leaves that folder: nothing is deleted.
- **A .zip file. Export** › **Full project (.zip)** takes everything (text, settings, images and PDFs). **Import a project (.zip)…** puts it in an empty folder and never overwrites a project.

> **ONEDRIVE**
> OneDrive doesn't work for syncing with an iPhone or iPad: iOS doesn't let an app pick a OneDrive folder (it appears greyed out in the picker). On a computer, a OneDrive folder works as a cloud folder, but only between computers. To connect a PC and an iPhone, use Dropbox.

On iPhone and iPad the app reloads the open project every 20 seconds and when you come back to it. On a computer, it sees changes as soon as they arrive in the folder.

> **AVOID**
> Don't write on two devices at the same time: syncing sometimes takes a few seconds. If the same file changed on both sides, the app keeps both versions and lets you choose.

To delete a project from all your devices: on iPhone and iPad, the cross on the projects page; on a computer, move its folder to the trash (in the Finder: iCloud Drive › MondoWrite › projets).

Editing outside MondoWrite

You can edit a project file with other software, or from another computer through a synced folder. The app notices and picks up the new version. If the same file changed on both sides, neither is overwritten: the version on disk is kept, yours is saved next to it ("… (MondoWrite).md"), and a banner lets you choose: **Keep mine** or **Keep the disk version**.

If saving fails

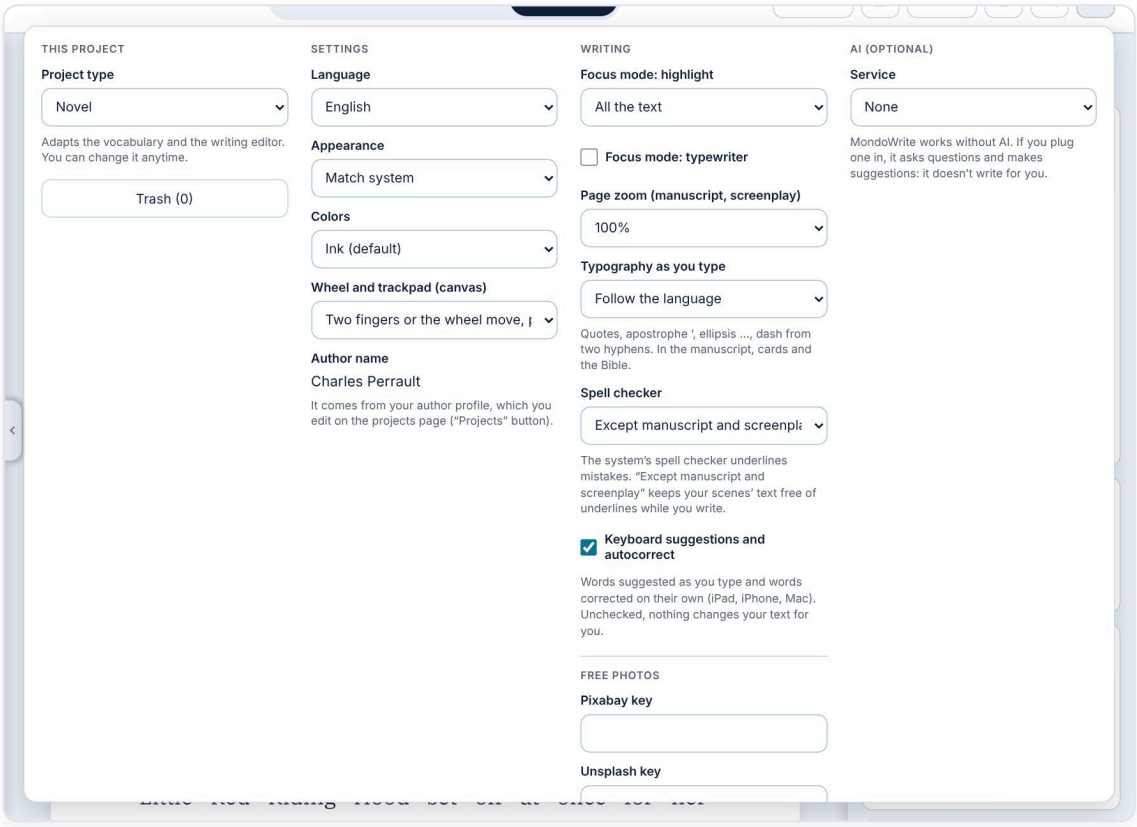
A message under the top bar says why (disk full, insufficient rights, folder not found) and offers: **Try again**; **Locate the project folder…** if it was moved or renamed; **Export a copy…** (the whole project in a .zip file, so nothing is lost); or **Back to projects without saving**.

> **BACKUPS**
> Keep your projects in a synced folder (iCloud Drive, Dropbox, OneDrive) or back them up regularly. Since they are text files, they take up very little space.

CHAPTER 13

Settings and appearance

The **Settings** button (the sliders, at the top right) opens three columns.



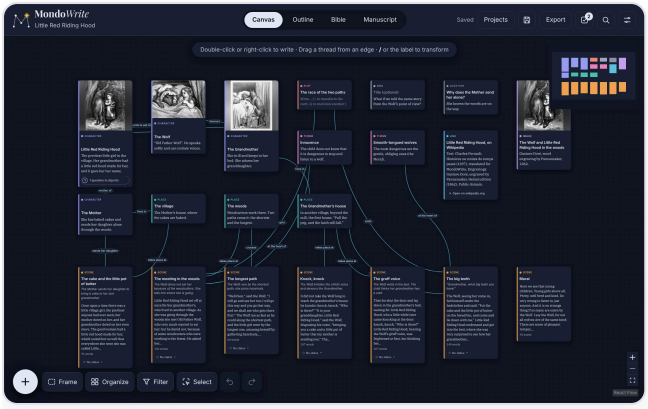
Settings.

Setting	Effect
This project	Project type (novel or screenplay); for a screenplay, the page size and numbering options; Markdown copies; the **Trash**.
Language	English or French. The first time, the system's language.
Appearance	Match system, light or dark.
Typography as you type	Follow the language, French, English or none.
Spell checker	Except manuscript and screenplay (on demand), everywhere or nowhere.
Keyboard suggestions and autocorrect	Words suggested and corrected by the system keyboard, or none.
Author name	Read from your profile, edited on the projects page.
Free photos	The Pixabay and Unsplash keys (Openverse needs none).
AI (optional)	The service, the key or address, the model.
Updates	The check at launch and the check button (desktop app).

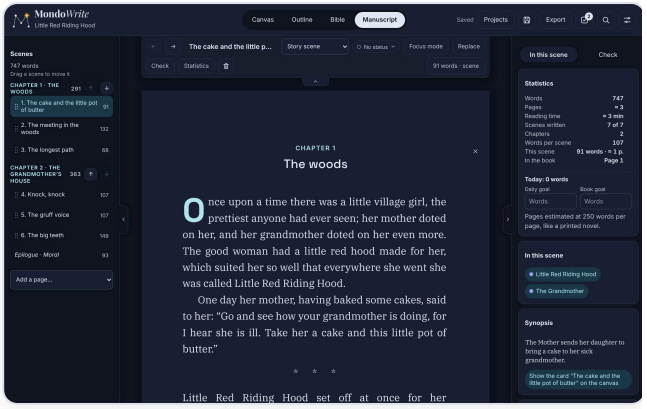
At the bottom: **Guided tour**, **User guide** (this guide, opened in your browser), **Keyboard shortcuts** and **About MondoWrite**. The guide also opens anywhere with `F1`, right at the chapter for the view you are in, and, on a Mac, from the **Help** menu in the menu bar, which follows the app's language. Language, appearance, keys and profile are device settings; the project type and the paperback settings are kept in the project.

Dark mode

The whole app exists in dark, down to the manuscript page. Choose **Dark**, or **Match system** to follow your computer.



The canvas in dark mode.



The manuscript in dark mode.

With a finger

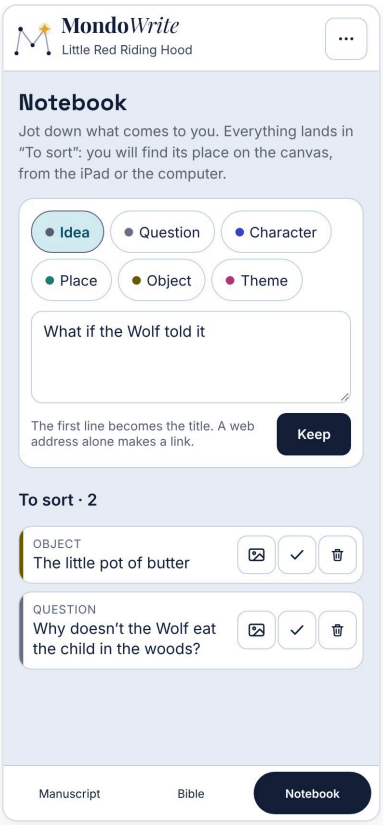
On a touch screen, everything works with a finger: a long press on a card lifts it (it is selected, with a drop shadow) so you can move it, a long press inside an unlocked frame lifts the frame with its cards, tapping a card's label changes its type, the **Select** button lets you draw around cards, and every drag-and-drop action also has a button.

On iPhone: the Notebook

On a phone, MondoWrite becomes a notebook: three tabs at the bottom, **Manuscript** (or **Screenplay**), **Bible** and **Notebook**. The canvas, the Outline, the exports and ordering the Bible's sections stay on the iPad and the computer, where they have room. The screen width decides: an unfolded foldable iPhone, or a wider window, gets everything back.

In the **Notebook**, choose the kind of note (**Idea**, **Question**, **Character**, **Place**, **Object**, **Theme**), write it, then **Keep**. The first line becomes the title, the rest the text; a web address alone makes a Link card. The note is a card of the project right away: it is in the Bible, and on the canvas of your other devices.

Your notes wait in **To sort**, below the field: touch a note to open its entry, the image icon to attach a photo, the check mark to mark it sorted, the trash to throw it away. On the iPad or the computer, the canvas's **To sort · N** button lists them, each with a dotted outline on the canvas; touching a note in the list spotlights it. As soon as you move it on the canvas or link it to another card, it leaves the list.



The Notebook on iPhone: a note being written, two others to sort.

CHAPTER 14

Keyboard shortcuts

The full list opens at any time with Ctrl / . On a Mac, Ctrl becomes ⌘ and Alt becomes ⌥.

Everywhere

Ctrl /	The list of shortcuts
Ctrl 1 … 4	Canvas, Outline, Bible, Manuscript
Ctrl F	Search for a card or a passage
Ctrl + − 0	Page zoom (Manuscript, Screenplay): in, out, normal size
Ctrl Shift H	Find and replace in the text
Ctrl Shift L	To do
Ctrl S	Save
Ctrl Z · Ctrl Shift Z	Undo · Redo

Canvas

N	New card
C	New frame (around the selection)
/	Change type (at the start of a line, or in an empty title)
@ or [[	Mention another card
Ctrl Enter	Expand the selected card
Alt ← →	Widen or narrow the card
Shift + drag	Draw around several cards
Ctrl + click	Add a card to the selection
Ctrl A · Esc	Select all · Deselect all
Delete	Move the selection to the trash
Ctrl C · Ctrl V	Copy the selected cards · Paste cards, a link, an image or text (into the focused card)
Ctrl D	Duplicate the selected cards

Text (cards, Bible, manuscript)

Ctrl B · Ctrl I	Bold · Italic

Ctrl Shift D	Strikethrough
Ctrl Alt 1 … 3	Title, heading
Ctrl Shift 8 · 7	Bulleted list · Numbered list
Ctrl Shift 9	Checkbox
Ctrl Shift B	Quote
Ctrl Shift X	Mark “to revisit”
** * # - [ ]	Markdown as you type and paste

Manuscript

Enter Enter	Split the scene (on an empty line)
Enter Enter Enter	New chapter
/ + name	Create a character or place card (or select a name, then /)
Ctrl Shift K	Send the selected passage to the Graveyard
Ctrl Shift F · Esc	Focus mode · Leave it
Alt ↑ ↓	Move the scene (scenes column)

Screenplay

Tab · Shift Tab	Change element
Enter	Next element
Esc	Element bar (or leave focus mode)
Ctrl Shift K	Send the selected passage to the Graveyard
Alt ↑ ↓	Move the scene (scenes column)

CHAPTER 15

Frequently asked questions

Where are my texts saved?

In the folder you chose when creating the project. The path isn't shown in the app: find it with **Open folder...**, or search your computer for the `cosmos.json` file.

How do I work on two computers?

Choose the same cloud folder (Dropbox, iCloud Drive or OneDrive) on both computers with **Choose a cloud folder...**: their projects show up on both sides. Between two Macs, iCloud does it by itself. See "Syncing between devices". Avoid writing on both at the same time: if a file changes on both sides, the app keeps both versions and lets you choose.

I deleted a card by mistake.

Ctrl Z, or the message's **Undo** button, or **Settings** › **Trash** › **Restore**. A scene's text is never erased with its card.

How do I turn a novel into a screenplay?

Settings › **This project** › **Project type**. Cards, the Bible and files don't change. The first time, scenes become screenplay headings and their synopsis comes along; the prose text stays in the manuscript, available if you switch back to the novel.

My paperback PDF has too few pages.

KDP requires at least 24 pages. A smaller trim (5 × 8) or a table of contents and back pages add a few pages; otherwise the text is simply too short for a paperback.

The AI doesn't answer.

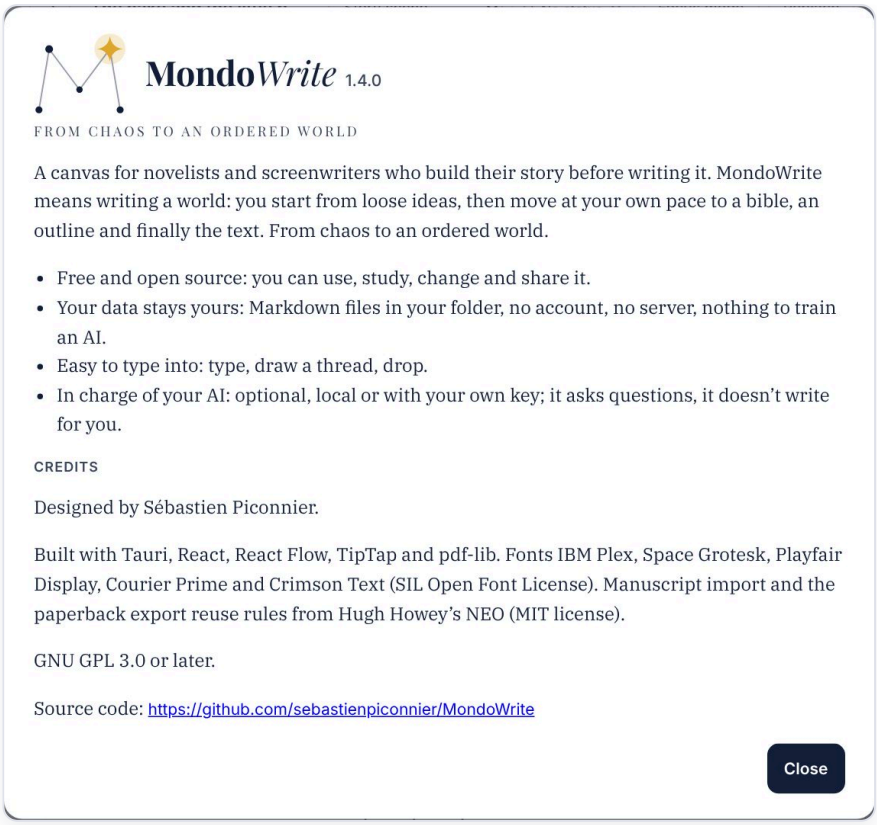
For Ollama or LM Studio, check that the software is running and a model is loaded, then **Test and list models**. For an online service, check the API key and your credit. The error message says what is blocking.

My photo can't be described.

The chosen model must be able to read images (for example gemma3, qwen2.5vl or llava with Ollama).

Is MondoWrite free?

Yes. MondoWrite is free software (GNU GPL 3.0 or later licence): you can use, study, modify and share it. The source code is at github.com/sebastienpiconnier/MondoWrite. It is inspired, among others, by NEO, Hugh Howey's writing software.



About MondoWrite.